

MODULE 1. Foundations of Clear Administrative Writing

Module Guide

Module 1 gives you the basic writing skills for the rest of the book. In this module, you learn how to write clear sentences, use a professional tone, and build a paragraph that is easy to follow. Each unit asks you to compare a weaker version with a stronger version, explain why the stronger version helps the reader, and revise your own writing.

The three units move from individual sentences to complete paragraphs:

- Unit 1 focuses on sentence structure — writing short, clear sentences that are easy for a workplace reader to process quickly.
- Unit 2 develops professional tone — choosing language that sounds polite and appropriate for different workplace relationships.
- Unit 3 brings these skills together at the paragraph level, where sentence structure and tone combine to create organised, reader-ready text.

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

- write short sentences with a clear main message
- choose tone that sounds polite and professional
- organise one paragraph so the reader can follow the idea from start to finish

Use each part of this module to help your writing:

- compare the weaker and stronger examples
- read the explanation about why the stronger version works
- use the self-check before freer practice
- use the editing practice to repair common reader problems
- finish the transfer extension so the skill works in a new situation

1

Clear Sentence Structure

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- write short clear sentences using basic subject-verb-object or subject-verb-complement patterns.
- rewrite long or indirect sentences in a simpler administrative style.
- write a short work-related message using clear sentence structure.

A. WARM-UP



NOTICE

Sentence Comparison

Read the pairs of sentences. Choose the one that feels **clearer**.

#	A	B
1	The document was, after some discussion in the meeting yesterday, finally checked by Mr. Sato.	Mr. Sato finally checked the document after the meeting yesterday.
2	It is requested that you will kindly send, as soon as it is convenient, the missing form.	Please send the missing form as soon as possible.
3	The application which was submitted by the applicant last week has some missing information.	The application submitted last week has some missing information.

Discussion: Which sentences are easier to read, and why?



LEARN

Quick Check

For a clear sentence:

- Put the main subject near the beginning.
- Use one clear main verb.
- Put the most important information in the main sentence, not in a long extra phrase.
- Remove words that do not change the meaning.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Look at the second pair from the Warm-Up again. Compare the weaker and stronger versions. Notice how the clearer version shows the main action earlier.

Weak

It is requested that you will kindly send, as soon as it is convenient, the missing form.

Stronger

Please send the missing form as soon as possible.



LEARN

Why This Works

Version B works better because the reader can see the action immediately:

1. send
2. the missing form
3. as soon as possible

The weaker version makes the reader wait too long before the real action appears.

C. LANGUAGE



STRUCTURE

Basic Sentence Pattern

Most clear administrative English sentences follow this simple pattern:

Subject + Verb + Object/Complement

Examples:

- We (S) received (V) your application (O).
- The applicant (S) submitted (V) the missing form (O).
- Our office (S) is located in (V) Tokyo (C).
- The system (S) is (V) busy (C).
- The documents (S) are (V) ready (C).



NOTICE

Practice: Identify the Parts

Identify the parts of each sentence: **underline** the subject, **circle** the verb, and **highlight** the object or complement.

1. Our office received your email yesterday.
2. The applicant submitted the additional documents.
3. We will check the application today.
4. The system shows an error message.
5. The examiner requested more information.

**Practice: Build Clear Sentences**

Rewrite the word groups as clear SVO or SVC sentences.

1. application / our office / receive / yesterday

2. examiner / request / more information

3. we / send / confirmation email / tomorrow

4. applicant / not / submit / fee / yet

5. system / show / error message / this morning

**Simplification Strategies**

Administrative English should be **short, direct, and clear**. Use these three moves when you simplify a sentence:

1. Change long formal openings to direct verbs.
2. Cut extra explanation that the reader does not need.
3. Move the main action closer to the subject.

**Simplify the Sentence**

Rewrite each sentence in a clearer, shorter way.

1. With reference to your email which was sent to our section yesterday afternoon, we are now in the process of checking the details.

-
2. It has been decided by our department that the deadline for submission of the documents will be extended until 30 June.

-
3. Due to the fact that the system is currently under maintenance, it is not possible for us to access your file at this moment in time.

-
4. In the situation where the applicant does not provide the required documents, we will not be able to continue the examination.
-

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Build a Clear Mini Message

Read the situation. Then write a short **4-sentence** message. Use the sentence jobs to help you build the message step by step.

Situation: Your office is checking an application. The document attached to the applicant's email is not the same as the document discussed on Monday. Your office needs to confirm the information with another department before replying.

Sentence jobs:

1. State that the application is being checked.
 2. Explain the document problem.
 3. Explain why more time is needed.
 4. State the next step clearly.
-
-
-
-

E. FREER PRACTICE

WRITE Write Clear Administrative Sentences

Situation: An applicant sent the wrong form. You need to contact the applicant and ask for the correct form. The deadline is next Friday.

Write a short message to the applicant in **3-4 clear sentences**. Include:

- the problem
- what the applicant needs to send
- the deadline

F. EDITING PRACTICE

EDIT Fix the Reader Problem

Sometimes the reader cannot understand the message clearly.

Common problem types:

- A. Main action is hidden
- B. Extra detail is too long
- C. Passive or indirect wording
- D. Unnecessary purpose phrase

Each sentence below has one clarity problem. First label it with A-D from the list above. Then rewrite it so the main point is easier to understand.

1. The file, which was sent by the applicant after the meeting that was held on Monday, is now being checked by our office. (____)

2. It has been explained by the supervisor that a new review step will be necessary for the application. (____)

3. Because there were several items in the form which were not complete and because the database was also unavailable, the check could not continue. (____)

4. We are writing for the purpose of asking you to send the correct version of the attached file. (____)

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

Final Self-Check

After you write the applicant message in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Does each sentence have a clear subject?
- ☐ Does each sentence have a clear verb?
- ☐ Did you remove words that the reader does not need?
- ☐ Is your request clear?

Reflection

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. What was difficult for you in this unit?
2. Which point do you want to remember when you write emails at work?

3. Choose one clear sentence you wrote today and rewrite it here.

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

WRITE Turn Sentences into a Mini Message

Choose **one** of the situations below.

- A. A form is missing one page.
- B. A meeting time has changed.
- C. A file needs to be checked again.

For your first draft, write two simple sentences:

- 1. State the main issue.
- 2. State the next important fact.

Then write a final 3-4 sentence message. Use the same information, but make it sound like a short professional message.

WRITE Homework Task

Choose one real email you sent at work (in Japanese). Translate the **main message** into 3-4 clear English sentences using SVO structure.

If you do not want to use a real email, use one of the Unit 1 situations or your Unit 1 freer-practice draft instead.

2

Professional Tone Basics

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- make a short request sound more polite and professional.
- rewrite direct or emotional wording in a neutral workplace style.
- write a short professional email for a simple administrative situation.

A. WARM-UP



NOTICE Which Sounds More Professional?

Choose one sentence in each row that sounds **more appropriate** for workplace communication.

#	A	B
1	Send me the file.	Could you please send me the file?
2	I don't understand this. Explain it.	I'm not sure I understand this part. Could you explain it?
3	What do you want me to do?	Could you let me know what I should do next?

Which sentences sound more professional, and why?



LEARN Professional Tone

Professional tone usually does three things. It:

- sounds polite, not demanding
- explains the situation clearly
- focuses on the task, not on blame or emotion

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Read the two versions. Notice how one version asks for help without blaming the reader.

Version A

I don't understand this. Explain it.

Version B

I'm not sure I understand this part. Could you explain it?

**Why This Works**

Version B is better because it:

- reduces pressure on the reader
- sounds cooperative, not demanding
- keeps the focus on the task, not on blame

Professional tone does not mean “very formal words only.” It means the reader can cooperate without feeling attacked.

C. LANGUAGE

Administrative emails often use **softened, polite expressions**.

**Useful Phrases for Requests**

- Could you please...?
- Would it be possible to...?
- Could you let me know...?
- I would appreciate it if you could...
- Please let me know if...

**Practice: Make the Request Polite**

Rewrite each direct sentence as a polite request. Use one phrase from the list above.

1. Send the updated form.

2. Tell me the deadline.

3. Check the file.

4. Give me the information.



LEARN

Check the Tone

Use these questions about different points in tone to check whether a workplace message sounds professional.

Point	Goal	Check
Clear	The message is not too long or complicated.	Does it tell the reader what they need to know?
Neutral	The message is not emotional or blaming.	Does it avoid emotional or blaming language?
Respectful	The message is polite and calm.	Does it sound calm enough to send at work?

A calm professional message helps the reader focus on the information instead of the tone.



REWRITE

Change the Tone

Rewrite each sentence in a more neutral, professional tone. Keep the same basic meaning.

1. You didn't send the document.

2. I can't do this because the system is broken.

3. That information is wrong.

4. I already told you this yesterday.



LANGUAGE

Useful Phrases by Function

Use these phrases when you need to give information, ask a question, or refer to an earlier message.

Giving Information

- I would like to inform you that...
- Please note that...
- I would like to confirm that...

Asking for Clarification

- Could you clarify...?
- I have one question regarding...
- I'm not sure I understand...

Referring to Previous Communication

- As mentioned in my previous email,...
- As discussed,...
- Thank you for your message regarding...

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

Read the email below. Why is it weak?

Original Email

Hi,
You didn't send the right file.
Send the correct one today. I need it now.



REWRITE

Improve the Email

Rewrite it as a **3-4 sentence** professional email. Keep the same purpose: Ask for the correct file today. Include:

- a short greeting
- a clear problem statement
- a polite request

Write with a calm, professional tone.

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Your Own Professional Email

Choose one situation below.

- A. Write to a colleague who needs to check a document today.
- B. Write to an applicant to confirm the correct deadline.
- C. Write to a colleague to ask for clarification about one part of an application.

Then write a short professional email in **3-4 sentences**. Include:

- a clear opening
- one polite request or clarification question
- a professional closing line

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Remove the Tone Problem

Rewrite each sentence so it keeps the same purpose but sounds more professional. Do not add new facts.

1. You sent the wrong file again.

2. Tell me what happened.

3. Why didn't you check this before?

4. Send the update today.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

Final Self-Edit

After you write the email in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your Activity E email again:

- ☐ Did you greet the reader politely?
- ☐ Did you explain your purpose clearly?
- ☐ Did you use one polite request or clarification phrase?
- ☐ Does the message sound calm and professional?

Underline the most professional sentence in your Activity E email.

Reflect on This Unit

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which polite expression do you want to remember?
2. What tone problem do you want to avoid in your emails?
3. Write one example of a polite request you can use at work.

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

WRITE Same Message, Better Relationship

Choose a simple workplace request. Do not use private information. If you do not want to use a real workplace request, use one of the Activity E situations instead. Write one sentence on each line where possible.

First write two short versions of the same request:

1. A direct version you should **not** send

2. A professional version you **could** send

Then write short notes about:

- what changed
- why the professional version is better for the reader
- which phrase from today you used

WRITE Homework Task

Find one English email you received that had a **very polite** tone or a tone that sounded **too direct**. Do not copy private information. Make brief notes:

- What part sounded polite or too direct?
- How would you rewrite it in a more professional way?

If you do not want to use a real email, use the weak email in Activity D or one of the Activity E situations instead.

3

Paragraph Structure

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify the main parts of a paragraph.
- keep one paragraph focused on one main idea.
- write a short administrative paragraph with a topic sentence, supporting details, and a closing sentence.

A. WARM-UP

Read both paragraphs. Decide which one is **better organised**.

Paragraph A

We reviewed the updated guidelines yesterday. During the review, we found several sections that were unclear and inconsistent with earlier versions. These inconsistencies may cause confusion for staff who use the document. Additional notes will be compiled before we continue with the next stage of the review.

Paragraph B

We reviewed the updated guidelines yesterday. The office renovation will begin next month. Several sections in the document were unclear. Our team attended a training session last week.

Discussion: Which paragraph is better organised, and why?

B. EXAMPLE CHECK



Why Paragraph A Works

Paragraph A is stronger because every sentence connects to one main idea: the review of the updated guidelines.

The paragraph also moves in a clear order. First, the team reviewed the guidelines. Then the team found unclear sections. Next, the paragraph explains why those unclear sections may create a problem for staff. The final sentence explains what will happen before the next stage.

Paragraph B is weaker because it mixes unrelated topics. A workplace paragraph should help the reader follow one idea without stopping to reorganise the information.

C. LANGUAGE

STRUCTURE Three-Part Paragraph Structure

Example of Paragraph Structure

We reviewed the applicant's file yesterday (T). During the review, we found that two pages were missing (S). One form was also incomplete (S). These issues will be recorded before the next review stage begins (C).

A clear administrative paragraph usually has three jobs. The **topic sentence (T)** states the main idea and tells the reader what the paragraph is about. The **supporting details (S)** give the facts, reasons, or examples the reader needs. The **closing sentence (C)** gives the result, next point, or link forward.

NOTICE Identify the Parts

Read each of the paragraph sentences. Write **T** for topic sentence, **S** for supporting detail, or **C** for closing sentence in the space after each sentence.

Paragraph 1

1. We processed your request this morning. (____)
2. The attached form was incomplete. (____)
3. The missing information will be checked before we proceed to the next step. (____)

Paragraph 2

1. The system was updated last night. (____)
2. Some users reported error messages after the update. (____)
3. These observations will be included in the technical report that follows. (____)

LEARN Logical Flow Inside a Paragraph

A paragraph should follow one clear path. Before you write, decide the main point, the detail the reader needs, and how the paragraph will close. If you:

- explain a problem, move from (1) the issue to (2) the detail and then to (3) the effect.
- give background, start with (1) the main event, add (2) the useful detail, and finish with (3) the result.
- summarise a review, first say (1) what was reviewed, then say (2) what was found, and then (3) explain what the finding means for the record or next step.

Review Summary Example

We reviewed the payment records this morning. During the review, we found that one receipt was missing from the file. This missing receipt should be noted before the monthly summary is completed.



STRUCTURE

Build a Short Review Summary

Put the sentences below in a logical order for a short **review summary**. The paragraph should first say what was checked, then say what was found, and then explain what the finding means.

Sentences:

- A. Two forms were missing from the submission.
- B. We checked the application yesterday.
- C. These issues form part of the initial documentation review.

Write the best order with the sentence letters only.

Then write **one supporting sentence** for the same review summary: Explain why the missing forms matter for the review.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



WRITE

Build a Paragraph From Facts

Read the situation and facts. Then write one clear paragraph of **4-5 sentences**.

Situation: Your office is preparing an internal update about an application review.

Facts:

- The review started yesterday.
- One required document was missing.
- The applicant sent an older version of the form.
- The review cannot move to the next stage yet.
- Your office will prepare a follow-up request.

Your paragraph should begin with one clear topic sentence. It should then give two or three supporting details and finish with one closing sentence that gives the next point.

E. FREER PRACTICE

WRITE Write One Administrative Paragraph

Choose **one** situation below. Write **one paragraph** of **4-5 sentences** for an internal update or short report.

Use the facts provided. Do not add a request or greeting.

1. **Review delay:** One review stage is delayed because two documents need to be checked again. The team needs one more day, and the updated result will be added to the review record.
2. **System problem:** Staff could not open several files this morning because the system showed an error message. IT checked the problem before lunch, and the affected files will be reviewed again this afternoon.
3. **Rule change:** The office changed one internal filing rule because the old rule created confusion for new staff. The new rule uses one standard file name, and the change will help staff find documents faster.

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Repair the Paragraph Logic

This paragraph has one unrelated sentence and one missing closing point.

Original

The file review started this morning. The office printer will be replaced next week. Two sections of the form were incomplete. These missing sections may delay the next stage.

First, cross out the unrelated sentence. Then rewrite the remaining information as a clear paragraph of **3-4 sentences**. Add one closing sentence that explains the next point.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Self-Check

Check your paragraph from Activity E or Activity F.

- ☐ Does the first sentence show the topic clearly?
- ☐ Do the middle sentences stay on the same idea?
- ☐ Does the final sentence close the paragraph or lead forward?
- ☐ Did I avoid mixing unrelated topics?
- ☐ Can I mark the paragraph as T, S, and C?

 WRITE **Reflection**

Answer these questions:

- What is one thing you learned about paragraph structure?
- When should you start a new paragraph?
- Which part is most difficult for you: topic, support, or closing?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 WRITE **Use the Paragraph Structure**

Choose one task from Unit 1 or Unit 2. Use the same basic information, but write it as **one internal paragraph of 4-5 sentences**.

Your paragraph should include one topic sentence, two or three supporting sentences, and one closing sentence.

Do not write an email greeting, request, or closing phrase. Make it sound like part of an internal note or short report.

 WRITE **Homework Task**

Find one short workplace paragraph in English or Japanese. Rewrite it in English using the structure from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real workplace paragraph, revise your Activity E paragraph instead.

Module 1 Review Workshop

KEY LESSONS TO KEEP



LEARN Core Takeaways

- Unit 1: A clear sentence usually carries one main message, with a visible subject, a controlled verb, and no unnecessary detours.
- Unit 2: Professional tone is not only about being polite. It is about helping the reader cooperate instead of react defensively.
- Unit 3: A paragraph becomes easier to read when the topic, support, and closing work together instead of competing for attention.

REVIEW CASE COMPARISON

Read these two versions of the same message. Decide which version is easier to read quickly, tells the reader exactly what to do next, and uses a stronger paragraph structure.

Version A

The office checked many things yesterday and there was also a discussion, and because of that your request is not complete and maybe you need to send more information soon.

Version B

We checked your request yesterday. At present, one required document is missing. Please send the missing document by Friday so that we can continue the review.



WRITE Review Response

Write **2-3 sentences** explaining which version is stronger. Mention sentence clarity, tone, and paragraph structure.

REVISION LAB

Weak Draft

We checked your application yesterday and there are some problems and we need more information and also the office is busy now so please reply quickly because the review cannot continue.



Improve the Weak Draft

Read the weak draft. Then improve it in three steps: split the long sentence into smaller sentences, change wording that sounds sudden or forceful, and end with a clear next action for the reader.



Check Your Revision

After you revise, check these three points:

- Does each sentence have one clear job?
- Does the request sound cooperative?
- Does the final sentence show the next step clearly?

SELF-EDIT ROUTINE



Check and Revise Your Writing

Choose one piece of your own writing from Units 1-3. Use the checklist, then revise one sentence and one paragraph.

- ☐ Circle the main action verb in each sentence.
- ☐ Underline any sentence that feels too long.
- ☐ Check whether the tone sounds neutral and professional.
- ☐ Mark the paragraph as T, S, and C to test whether the structure is complete.

- ☐ Rewrite one sentence and one paragraph so the reader can understand the message faster.

Revised sentence

Revised paragraph

TRANSFER TASK

 WRITE Write an Integrated Message

Choose one simple workplace topic, such as a missing document, a meeting update, or a request for confirmation.

Write one short internal message of **5-6 sentences**. Include:

- two clear sentences that show Unit 1 sentence control
- one polite request or explanation that shows Unit 2 tone control
- one clear paragraph with a topic, support, and closing that shows Unit 3 organisation

After writing, add three short notes:

1. Where did you improve sentence clarity?
2. Where did you control tone?
3. Where did you organise the paragraph for the reader?

PREPARATION FOR MODULE 2



Ready for Email Writing?

Before you start the email module, check whether you can do these four things without help:

- ☐ write one clear purpose sentence
- ☐ soften a request without losing the main meaning
- ☐ build one short paragraph with a topic, support, and closing
- ☐ explain why your revised version is easier for the reader to understand

If one of these still feels weak, return to the unit that teaches it and revise one more piece of writing before moving on.

MODULE 2. Essential Email Writing for Administrative Contexts

Module Guide

Module 2 builds on Module 1 and focuses on workplace email writing. In this module, you learn how to write emails that are clear, polite, and easy to answer. As you move through the units, pay attention to how email purpose changes the order, tone, and level of detail.

The four units move through progressively demanding email writing tasks:

- Unit 4 introduces email layout and standard phrases — the visual and language conventions that make a workplace email easy to read and respond to.
- Unit 5 develops the skill of requesting clarification — writing short, focused emails that ask one clear question without sounding abrupt.
- Unit 6 addresses communicating delays or changes — explaining unwelcome information in a way that keeps the reader informed without sounding apologetic or vague.
- Unit 7 extends the range to making requests politely — choosing language that matches the relationship and avoids pressure.

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

- organise a short professional email that is easy to scan
- ask for clarification or action without sounding abrupt
- explain delays or changes without creating confusion
- choose polite request language that matches the relationship and context

Use each part of this module to help your writing:

- compare the example versions before you draft
- use the “Why this works” notes to understand reader effect
- check the self-edit prompts before freer writing
- use the editing tasks to repair weak requests and unclear email structure
- finish the transfer extension so the skill works in a new email situation

4

Email Layout and Standard Phrases

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify the main parts of a professional email.
- write a short, clear subject line for a workplace email.
- write a simple professional email with an appropriate opening and closing.

A. WARM-UP

**NOTICE What Makes an Email Clear?**

Before you compare full emails, think about what helps a professional email work well.

Write two features that make an email clear and professional.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Read the two emails and choose which one is clearer and more professional.

Email A

Subject: Question
Hi,
I don't understand this part.
Can you tell me what it means?
Thanks,

Email B

Subject: Question About Application Form
Dear Ms. Tanaka,
I have a question about the new application form.
Could you clarify the purpose of Section 3?
Please let me know if you need any further information.

Thank you,
[Name]

Discussion: Which email is more professional, and why?

 LEARN Why Email B Works Better

Email B is stronger because every part has a clear job:

- the subject line names the topic
- the greeting is professional
- the first sentence gives the reason for writing
- the question is specific
- the closing sentence and sign-off are polite

Email A is not wrong because it is short. It is weak because the reader still has to ask:

- what part is unclear?
- what document is the writer talking about?
- who is the writer writing to?

A professional email helps the reader act quickly. The reader should understand the purpose without guessing.

C. LANGUAGE

 STRUCTURE Basic Email Layout

A professional email has a **clear structure** so that the reader can easily understand the purpose.

1. **Subject line** - a short summary of the purpose
2. **Greeting** - polite opening
3. **Opening sentence** - main purpose of the email
4. **Body** - details, explanation, or information
5. **Closing sentence** - final point or next step (not a command)
6. **Sign-off** - polite closing phrase + name

 LEARN Quick Email Check

- Does the subject line show the topic clearly?
- Does the first sentence tell the reader why you are writing?
- Does the body give the needed detail or question?
- Does the closing sound polite and professional?

 LANGUAGE Subject Lines

A good subject line is **short, clear, and specific**.

Examples of Clear Subject Lines

- Question About Missing Signature on Form B
- Information Needed for March Application Review
- Update on Monday System Maintenance
- Request for Corrected Applicant ID File



Practice: Improve the Subject Line

Each subject line below is too long. Rewrite it as a short, clear phrase.

1. Subject: I have a question about the document that you sent to me yesterday

2. Subject: I want to ask you about when I should submit the missing form for the application

3. Subject: I am writing this email because there is a problem with the online system today

4. Subject: I need to know the reason why the applicant has not received the confirmation message yet



Email Openings and Closings

Use a polite opening and closing that match the reader.

Common Openings

- Dear Mr./Ms. [Name],
- Dear Team,
- Thank you for your email.

Common Closings

- Thank you.
- Kind regards,

- Best regards,
- Please let me know if you need further information.

 LANGUAGE **Opening Purpose Phrases**

Use the opening sentence to tell the reader why you are writing.

- I am writing to ask about...
- I would like to confirm...
- I have a question regarding...
- I would like to provide an update about...

 LEARN **Opening Sentence Job**

The opening sentence tells the reader **why you are writing**. It is not only a polite beginning — it also shows what kind of message this is:

- a question
- a confirmation
- an update
- a request

That helps the reader prepare for the rest of the email.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

 WRITE **Build the Email Step by Step**

Use the same skill parts from Section C to build one complete email.

Situation: You are writing to an applicant, Ms. Kim. You want to confirm the required documents for her application.

First choose an opening and closing for each situation.

1. You are writing to a colleague about an internal document.

2. You are writing to an applicant.

3. You are writing to a foreign office.

Now write a clear opening sentence for each situation.

1. You want to ask about a missing document.

2. You want to confirm a deadline.

3. You want to give information about a system update.

Then use this order to write one complete email for Ms. Kim.

Use this order:

1. Subject line:
2. Greeting:
3. Opening sentence:
4. Body (2-3 sentences):
5. Closing sentence:
6. Sign-off:

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Your Own Email

Choose one situation and write one complete email.

Situations

- A. Write to a colleague to ask for information about a new internal procedure.
- B. Write to an applicant to confirm the correct deadline.
- C. Write to a colleague or partner office to ask one clear question about a submitted file.

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Repair the Email Structure

Read the email below. Rewrite it using the six-part email structure from Activity A: subject line, greeting, opening sentence, body, closing sentence, and sign-off.

Original Email

Subject: Help
Hi,
I saw the file and I do not understand part of it and
maybe there is also a problem with one page so please
tell me what this means.
Thanks.

**Rewrite the Email**

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

**Self-Check**

After writing your email in Activity E, check:

- ☐ Can the reader understand the purpose from the subject line and first sentence?
- ☐ Is the question or information specific enough?
- ☐ Is the body short but complete?
- ☐ Does the closing sound professional?

**Reflection**

1. Which part of the email is easiest for you?
2. Which part is most difficult?
3. Which new phrase do you want to use in real emails?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

**Build Two Purpose Lines**

This helps you practise separating the job of the subject line from the job of the opening sentence.

For one situation below, write:

1. a clear subject line
2. a clear opening sentence

Choose one of these situations:

- A. asking about a missing document
- B. confirming a deadline
- C. giving an update about a review delay

Write one sentence on each line where possible.



Homework Task

Find one real email you sent recently (in Japanese or English). Rewrite it in English using the **email structure** from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real email, rewrite one of the Unit 4 freer-practice situations instead.

5

Requesting Clarification

FOCUS

Clarification means asking someone to make unclear information clearer.

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- write polite clarification questions about unclear or missing information.
- ask for specific details instead of writing a vague question.
- write a short clarification email about one clear problem.
- explain, in a short paragraph, why clarification is needed in a workplace situation.

A. WARM-UP

**NOTICE What Is Unclear?**

Read the sentences below. Identify what is **unclear** or **missing**.

1. The document is not correct.
2. Please check it again.
3. We need information about the form.
4. The deadline has changed.

Write what you would need to know for each sentence.

**LEARN A Strong Clarification Question**

A strong clarification question asks for clearer information. It does three things:

- names the exact part that is unclear
- asks for one specific piece of information
- stays polite and neutral

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Compare the two questions.

Question A

What do you mean?

Question B

Could you clarify which version of the form we should use for applications submitted this month?

**Why Question B Works Better**

Question B names the exact unclear point, limits the question to one topic, and helps the reader give a useful answer. Question A may sound frustrated and gives the reader no clear starting point.

C. LANGUAGE

**Asking for Clarification**

Use these phrases when the information is not clear.

- Could you clarify...?
- Could you explain...?
- I'm not sure I understand...
- Could you give me more information about...?
- I have a question regarding...

**Checking Your Understanding**

Use these phrases when you want to check that you understood correctly.

- Do you mean that...?
- Just to confirm,...
- Should I understand that...?

**Make These Questions Clearer**

Rewrite the questions to make them specific and professional.

Each stronger question should show what part is unclear and what information you need.

1. What do you mean?

2. I don't understand this part.

3. Tell me the details.

4. What should I do?



LEARN

Common Situations

Clarification questions are useful when the reader needs one exact answer before work can continue. In this unit, a clarification question means a polite question that makes unclear information clearer.

- The instructions are unclear.
- A document is missing or incomplete.
- Two versions of a document do not match.
- A process or requirement is not explained.



LANGUAGE

Example Clarification Questions

These examples name the unclear point and ask for one answer.

- Could you clarify which version of the form we should use?
- Could you explain what information is needed in Section 4?
- I'm not sure I understand the deadline: does it mean Friday or Monday?
- Could you confirm whether the applicant needs to submit this document now or later?



REWRITE

Improve the Clarity

Rewrite each sentence as a better clarification question.

1. This is different from what you said before.

2. The instructions are confusing.

3. I don't know what to write in this part.

4. The system doesn't work.

 WRITE Clarification from Context

Read each short scenario. Write **two clarification questions** for each one.

1. The instructions say: "Submit the form as soon as possible."

2. Two versions of a file are attached, both named "Application_Final".

3. A supervisor writes: "Please prepare the report." No details are given.

 REWRITE Rewrite and Improve

Rewrite each unclear message into a **clear, polite clarification request**.

1. I don't get this. Explain it.

2. Which one is correct? These files look different.

3. What am I supposed to do with this form?

4. This part is wrong.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Write a Clarification Email

Situation: You read instructions about a new form, but the information about **where to submit the form** is unclear.

Write one clarification email in **4-5 sentences**. Use this order:

1. Subject line
2. Greeting
3. Opening sentence
4. Clarification question
5. Closing sentence
6. Sign-off

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Two Clarification Emails

Choose **two** situations from the list below.

- A. The deadline notice and the form show different submission dates.
- B. Two attached files use the same name, and you need to confirm which version should be used for this month's review.
- C. A required attachment is missing from the document set, and you need to ask whether it should be sent now or in the next stage.
- D. The written instructions and the checklist use different wording, and you need to confirm which instruction your team should follow.

Write **two short emails**, each 3-4 sentences. Keep each email focused on **one topic only**.

Email 1:

Email 2:

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Fix the Clarification Problem

Rewrite each message as a better clarification request.

1. I don't understand this instruction.

2. The file names are confusing.

3. The deadline message is different from the form.

4. The supervisor said to prepare the report.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Self-Check

After writing your emails in Activity E and completing the editing practice in Activity F, check your work:

- ☐ Did I identify one clear unclear point?

- ☐ Did I ask a specific question?
- ☐ Did I avoid blame or frustration?
- ☐ Could the reader answer without asking me another question first?

 WRITE **Reflection**

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which clarification phrase is most useful for you?
2. Do you find it difficult to ask questions politely? Why or why not?
3. Write one clarification question you can use in your work.

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 REVISE **Clarification Summary Paragraph**

Choose one unclear situation from Activity E or another workplace situation. Write one **informational paragraph** of 5-6 sentences explaining why clarification is needed.

Use this order:

1. Short background
2. Unclear or missing point
3. Reason clarification is needed
4. Effect on the work
5. Neutral next-step line



Homework Task

Find an email or set of instructions you received recently. Identify **one unclear point** and write a clarification question about it in English.

If you do not want to use a real message, choose one Unit 5 freer-practice situation and write the clarification question for that case.

6

Communicating Delays or Changes

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- explain a delay or change using neutral professional language.
- organise an update message in a clear order.
- write a short update email about a delay or schedule change.
- summarise a delay or change in a short report-style paragraph.

A. WARM-UP

 What Information Is Missing?

Read each message and identify what information a reader would still need.

1. The review will be delayed.
2. The schedule has changed.
3. We cannot finish this today.
4. The system will be updated.

Write what the reader still needs to know for each message.

 A Useful Update Answers Four Questions

A useful update answers these questions:

1. What changed?
2. Why did it change?
3. What does this mean for the reader?
4. What happens next?

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Compare the two updates.

Update A

The review will be delayed.

Update B

The review will be delayed because two documents still need additional checks. A new schedule will be shared tomorrow.



LEARN

Why Update B Works Better

Update B tells the reader what changed, why it changed, and what happens next. This reduces uncertainty and extra follow-up questions.

C. LANGUAGE



LANGUAGE

Useful Phrases for Delays and Changes

Use neutral phrases so the update explains the situation without sounding emotional.

Neutral Phrases

- There will be a delay in...
- The schedule has been adjusted.
- The process will take longer than expected.
- There has been a change in...
- The update will affect...

Reasons

- due to additional checks
- because further review is required
- because the system is under maintenance
- due to missing information

Next Steps

- The next update will be provided when available.
- Further details will follow.
- The review will continue once all materials are ready.
- The new schedule will be shared shortly.



REWRITE

Improve the Clarity

Rewrite each message so it includes **clearer information**.

Use the phrase bank above to replace vague updates with information about what changed, which part of the work is affected, and what the reader should understand now.

1. The meeting is delayed.

2. We changed the procedure.

3. The file will be late.

4. The system is slow.



LEARN

Logical Order for Update Messages

A clear update message usually follows this pattern:

1. **Topic:** What is delayed or changed
2. **Reason:** Why (optional)
3. **Effect:** What this means for the reader
4. **Next step / What will happen later:** Neutral, not a request

Example Paragraph (Part of a Report or Update)

The review process will take longer than expected. Additional checks are required because two documents were incomplete. This delay may affect the planned schedule for the next stage. Further updates will be provided once the remaining documents are ready.



LEARN

Why This Order Works

The paragraph moves from topic to reason, then to effect, and finally to the next step. This order helps the reader understand both the situation and the practical meaning of the delay.



STRUCTURE

Reorder to Make a Clear Update

Put the sentences in a logical order.

Sentences:

- A. This may affect the planned timeline.
- B. The system will be under maintenance on Friday.
- C. Users may not be able to access certain functions.

Write the best order with the sentence letters only.



REWRITE

Add Supporting Information

Expand each message to 2-3 sentences by adding supporting information.

1. The deadline has been extended.

2. The applicant's file will be reviewed next week.

3. There has been a change in the procedure.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



WRITE

Write an Update Email

Situation: A review that was planned for this week must be delayed because additional verification is required.

Write one clear and neutral email explaining the delay. Use this order:

1. Subject line
2. Greeting
3. Opening sentence
4. Explanation of the delay (2-3 sentences)
5. Neutral next step
6. Sign-off

E. FREER PRACTICE



Choose a Scenario and Write

Choose **two** situations from the list below.

- A. Write to colleagues about a system update that will take longer than planned because one required check is still incomplete.
- B. Write to an applicant or partner office to explain that a document will be reviewed later than the original schedule because additional verification is required.
- C. Write to staff about a change in an internal rule because the old process created repeated filing problems.
- D. Write to meeting participants about a rescheduled meeting because the updated document set will not be ready in time.

Write **two short update emails**, each 3-4 sentences. In each email, include:

- the change or delay
- a short reason or background sentence if needed
- the effect or next step

Email 1:

Email 2:

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Remove the Reader's Uncertainty

Rewrite each update so the reader does not need to ask a second question.

1. The meeting changed.

2. We cannot finish this today.

3. There was a problem with the documents.

4. The system update will affect the process.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

Self-Check

After writing your emails in Activity E and completing the editing practice in Activity F, check your work:

- ☐ Did I state the change clearly?
- ☐ Did I add the reason or background if needed?
- ☐ Did I show the effect on the reader or schedule?
- ☐ Did I include a neutral next-step line?

Reflection

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. What phrases do you find most useful for explaining delays or changes?
2. Is it difficult for you to give neutral explanations without sounding too direct?
3. Which part of this unit was easiest or hardest for you?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION



Turn an Email Update into a Report Paragraph

Choose one update email you wrote in this unit. Rewrite it as a short internal report paragraph.

Keep the same core facts, but change the audience, tone, and final sentence so the text sounds like part of a report, not an email.



Homework Task

Find an email or notice about a delay or change (English or Japanese). Rewrite it in English using the structure from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real email or notice, rewrite one of the Unit 6 freer-practice scenarios instead.

7

Making Requests Politely

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- choose a polite request structure for a workplace email.
- make a request more specific and useful by adding the necessary detail.
- soften a request without making it unclear.
- write a short professional email requesting information or action.

A. WARM-UP



NOTICE Which Request Sounds More Appropriate?

Read each pair. Choose the request that sounds more professional.

#	A	B
1	Send me the file.	Could you please send me the file?
2	Tell me the deadline.	Could you let me know the deadline?
3	I need the applicant's number.	Could you provide the applicant's number?

Discussion: Which sentences are more polite, and what makes them that way?

A good request is polite, specific, and easy to answer. It tells the reader what action or information is needed, and it gives a short reason when the reason helps the reader understand the request.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Request A

Send the updated file.

Request B

Could you please send the updated file? We need it for the next review stage.



LEARN Why the Polite Version Works

Request B sounds cooperative rather than forceful. It also names the exact action and gives a short reason, so the reader can understand why the file is needed.

C. LANGUAGE

Different request forms sound **more or less polite**. In administrative writing, the best choice depends on your relationship with the reader, the urgency of the request, and the formality of the situation.



Politeness Scale (From Direct to Most Polite)

The table shows common request forms from direct to more formal.

Example request	Tone/Use
<u>Can you</u> send the file?	Casual, spoken English; too direct for administrative emails.
<u>Could you</u> send the file?	Standard polite request; appropriate for most situations.
<u>Could you please</u> send the file?	Polite and slightly more formal.
<u>Would you be able to</u> send the file?	Polite, softer, useful when asking for something more difficult.
<u>Would it be possible to</u> send the file?	Formal, respectful, avoids pressure.
<u>I would appreciate it if you could</u> send the file.	Very polite, used when the request requires effort or cooperation.



Choosing a Form

'Could you...?' is the safest default for most workplace emails. Use softer forms, such as 'Would you be able to...?' or 'I would appreciate it if...', when the request needs more effort or when the reader is outside your team.



Useful Context Sentences

One short context sentence can make a request easier to understand. Useful sentences include 'We need this for the next review stage.', 'This information is required for the submission.', and 'This will help us complete the process.'



Choose a Polite Request Form

Rewrite each direct message as one polite request sentence. Use a suitable form from the politeness scale.

1. Send the updated file.

1. Tell me the deadline.

-
1. Check this.

-
-
1. Give me the information.



Make the Request Specific

Each request below is polite, but it is not specific enough. Rewrite each one so the reader knows exactly what document, information, or action is needed.

Mini contrast

Weak: "Could you update me?"

Stronger: "Could you update me on whether the signed form has been uploaded to the shared folder?"

1. Could you send the document?

-
-
1. Could you check this?

-
-
1. Could you confirm the information?

-
1. Could you update me?

**Low-Pressure Phrases**

Administrative English avoids pressure words such as 'now', 'immediately', and 'ASAP' unless there is a real deadline. Softer alternatives include 'when available', 'when you have time', and 'at your convenience'.

**Reduce Pressure**

Rewrite each message so it is polite and low-pressure, but still clear.

1. Send this today.

1. Tell me the result now.

1. Check this immediately.

1. Give me the corrected file as soon as possible.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE**Write a Request Email**

Situation: You need to request the applicant's updated contact information for the next review stage.

Write a complete request email. Include these parts:

- Subject

- Greeting
- Opening sentence
- Request (1-2 sentences)
- Context / reason (1 sentence)
- Softened closing sentence
- Sign-off

E. FREER PRACTICE



Request Emails

Write **two short emails** (3-4 sentences each) requesting information or action. Choose two situations below.

Options

- Write to a colleague to confirm a meeting time because the draft agenda still depends on the final schedule.
- Write to a colleague or partner office to request the correct version of a submitted file because the current attachment does not match the review record.
- Write to an applicant to request information missing from their documents because the review cannot continue without that detail.
- Write to a colleague to request clarification before finalising a report because one section still lacks a confirmed figure.

In each email, include a clear opening, one polite request, a short reason, and a softened closing.

Email 1

Email 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Keep the Request, Improve the Tone

Rewrite each message so it keeps the same request but sounds more professional.

1. Send me the corrected file today.

1. Tell me the meeting time now.

1. Check this and reply quickly.

1. Give me the missing information.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

Self-Check

After writing your request email in Activity E, check:

- ☐ Is the request clear?
- ☐ Is the request specific enough?
- ☐ Did I add a short reason if it helps?
- ☐ Did I avoid pressure words or commands?

Reflection

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which polite request phrase do you prefer using?
2. Which softening phrase will you try in future emails?
3. When should a request be more formal?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

WRITE One Need, Two Levels of Politeness

Choose one real workplace request, or choose one Unit 7 freer-practice situation.

Write two versions of the same request:

1. A safe standard version using 'Could you...?'

2. A softer version using 'Would you be able to...?' or 'I would appreciate it if...'

Then write which version is better for a colleague and which version is better for an outside office.

WRITE Homework Task

Think of a real request you made at work this week. Rewrite it using **two different polite request structures** from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real request, choose one Unit 7 freer-practice situation and rewrite it using **two different polite request structures** instead.

Module 2 Review Workshop

KEY LESSONS TO KEEP

Module 2 showed how a short workplace email guides the reader. A good email makes the purpose clear from the subject line and opening sentence. Clarification questions should connect one question to one information need. Delay and change messages should reduce uncertainty. Request emails should match the reason, action, and tone to the reader.

EMAIL COMPARISON REVIEW

Compare these two request openings.

Version A

Send the updated file today. I need it for the report.

Version B

Could you please send the updated file today? I need it to complete the report before the afternoon deadline.



Review Response

Write **2-3 sentences** explaining why Version B is easier for the reader to act on. Mention tone, reason, and action.

REVISION LAB

Weak Email

Subject: Document

Hello,
About the form, there is a problem, so please send it
again soon because we need it.
Thank you.



Improve the Weak Email

Rewrite the weak email. Include a clearer subject line, a professional opening, the exact problem, and one polite request.

SELF-EDIT ROUTINE



Check and Revise One Email

Choose one email from Units 4-7. Use the checklist, then revise the weakest part of the email.

- ☐ Is the subject line specific enough?
- ☐ Does the opening sentence show the purpose early?
- ☐ If you ask a question, is it anchored to one clear information gap?
- ☐ If you report a delay or change, does the message state the current situation and next step?
- ☐ If you make a request, does the reason help the reader understand why the action matters?
- ☐ Does the closing tone fit the relationship?

Revised subject or opening

Revised email section

TRANSFER TASK



Write Two Audience Versions

Choose one workplace situation. Write one internal email and one external email about the same situation. Then add three short notes about what changed for the audience.

- you need missing information
- you need to explain a short delay
- you need to make a polite request to another office

Internal Email

External Email

After writing both emails, add three short notes about audience choices.

1. What stayed the same in both emails?
2. What changed because of audience?

3. Which module unit helped you make that decision?

PREPARATION FOR MODULE 3

Ready for Internal Communication?

Before you start the internal communication module, check whether you can do these four things without help:

- ☐ write a specific email subject line
- ☐ state the purpose in the opening sentence
- ☐ ask one clear question or make one clear request
- ☐ adjust detail and tone for the reader

If one of these still feels weak, return to the unit that teaches it and revise one more email before moving on.

MODULE 3. Writing Procedures & Internal Explanations

Module Guide

Module 3 focuses on internal documents. In this module, you write procedures, notices, problem explanations, and meeting summaries for readers inside your organisation. Because these readers often need to act after reading, clear order and clear logic are as important as grammar.

The four units address distinct but related internal document types:

- Unit 8 develops procedural writing — clear, ordered steps that another person can follow without asking questions.
- Unit 9 focuses on internal notices — short documents that explain a change, decision, or requirement to colleagues.
- Unit 10 develops the skill of explaining problems clearly — describing an issue in a logical order so the reader understands what happened, what the effect is, and what happens next.
- Unit 11 addresses meeting summaries — condensing what was discussed and decided into a short, useful record.

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

- write a simple procedure another person can follow
- produce an internal notice that explains change clearly
- describe a problem in a logical order
- summarise a meeting so the key outcomes are easy to use later

Use each part of this module to help your writing:

- compare the weaker and stronger versions before you draft
- practise the key structure before longer writing
- use the editing task to repair one weak example
- check your work with the self-check section
- use the homework and extension task in a new internal-writing situation

8

Writing Simple Procedures

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- write simple step-by-step instructions in a clear order.
- choose clear action verbs for procedure writing.
- write a short workplace procedure that another person can follow.

A. WARM-UP

Read both procedures. Choose the clearer one and explain one reason.

Version A

- Check the form.
- If it looks OK, then you can send it. But you might want to check the applicant ID first because sometimes it is wrong.
- After you check everything, send it.

Version B

1. Check the form for complete and correct information.
2. Confirm the applicant ID number.
3. Send the form to the next department.



LEARN

Why Version B Is Clearer

A **procedure** is a set of steps that explains how to complete a task. Version B is easier to follow because each step has one clear action, the steps are numbered, and the order matches the real task from start to finish.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Procedure Example

Steps to create a new file record:

1. Open the database system.
2. Select New Record from the main menu.
3. Enter the applicant's basic information.
4. Save the record and confirm the entry.



LEARN

Why This Works

This procedure works because the reader can see what to do first, what to do next, and when the task is complete. Procedures reduce mistakes when the steps follow the real order and each step has one job.

C. LANGUAGE

LANGUAGE

Clear Instruction Verbs**Common Procedure Verbs**

- check
- confirm
- review
- select
- enter
- attach
- save
- submit

Choose verbs that tell the reader exactly what action to take. Avoid vague verbs such as handle, do, or fix when a more exact action is possible.



REWRITE

Improve the Verb Choice

Rewrite each instruction using a **clear action verb**.

1. Make sure the file is OK.

1. Put the name in the system.

1. Look at the form to see if something is missing.

1. Send it to the right place.



LEARN

Step Order

If the order is wrong, even clear instructions can cause mistakes. A procedure is useful only when the reader can complete the task in the same order as the writer intended.



NOTICE

Put the Steps in Order

Put the steps for verifying an application in the correct order.

- A. Review the file for missing documents.
- B. Save the updated file.
- C. Enter the applicant's information into the system.
- D. Confirm the submission date.

Write the correct order using the letters only.



STRUCTURE

Add Missing Steps

Each procedure below is incomplete. Add **one or two steps** to make it clearer.

Procedure 1

- 1. Open the shared folder.
- 2. Download the file.

Procedure 2

- 1. Review the applicant's form.
- 2. Check for required signatures.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

WRITE Complete a Simple Procedure

Situation: A new team member needs to know how to save a document in the correct folder for your team.

Use the step notes below to write a clear procedure for that team member. Put the steps in the best order and turn them into **4-5 numbered steps**.

- open the shared team folder
- choose the correct subfolder for the document type
- rename the file using the team naming format
- save the document in that folder
- confirm the file appears correctly in the folder

E. FREER PRACTICE

WRITE Write a Workplace Procedure

Choose **one** situation below and write a clear workplace procedure for a new colleague.

- A. A new colleague needs to know how to prepare a file for internal review.
- B. A team member needs instructions for renaming and saving scanned documents.
- C. A new staff member needs to know how to check and update applicant information.

[illegible]

- ☐ Does the order match the real task?
- ☐ Will the user know when the task is finished?

 WRITE **Reflect on This Unit**

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. What is difficult about writing procedures?
2. Which instruction verbs are useful for your work?
3. Which step from your Activity E procedure is the clearest?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 WRITE **Real-World Procedure Task**

Choose one routine workplace task you know well. If you do not want to use a real workplace task, choose one Unit 8 freer-practice situation instead.

Write a short manual-style procedure. Include:

- one sentence explaining who the procedure is for
- a 5-7 step procedure
- one closing sentence explaining what happens after the task

9

Internal Notices

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify the main parts of an internal notice.
- write a short internal notice using neutral language.
- explain an internal update or change clearly for colleagues.

A. WARM-UP

 NOTICE What Makes a Notice Useful?

Before you compare full notices, think about what colleagues need from an internal notice.

Write two features that make an internal notice clear and useful.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Read both notices. Which notice is clearer and more useful? Give two reasons.

Notice A

There was a problem with the system today. Please be careful. We will check it. Thank you.

Notice B

System Notice - Temporary Error
A temporary system error occurred this morning. Some users may have experienced slow access. The issue is currently being reviewed by the IT team. An update will be provided later today.

 LEARN Why Notice B Works Better

Notice B is stronger because it gives the reader a usable structure:

1. topic
2. issue
3. current status
4. next update

Notice A feels weak because the reader still does not know what exactly happened, who is checking the problem, or what to expect next.

C. LANGUAGE



LEARN

Internal Notice Basics

A **notice** is a short message shared inside a department or organisation. It gives important information, explains updates or changes, and uses neutral language.



LEARN

Quick Notice Check

Use this checklist when you review or write a notice:

- Is the topic clear in the heading or first line?
- Does the reader understand what is happening?
- Is the message neutral and factual?
- Does the notice show what happens next?



STRUCTURE

Notice Structure

A clear internal notice usually includes:

1. Heading / Topic
2. Background or brief explanation
3. Essential information
4. Next step or what happens later (neutral, not a request)

Example Notice

Internal Notice - Document Review Schedule
The document review for this month will begin on 16 April. Teams may receive requests for additional information during this period. A summary of the review results will be shared in early May.



NOTICE

Identify the Parts

Label each part with: **H = Heading**, **B = Background**, **E = Essential information**, **N = Next step**.

1. The application review will take place next Wednesday. (____)
2. Internal Notice - Application Review (____)

3. Additional checks may be required for older files. (____)
4. More information will be shared after the review. (____)

 LEARN **Neutral Tone in Notices**

Internal notices use **neutral, factual language**. Avoid:

- Personal comments
- Emotional expressions
- Requests or instructions (unless necessary)

 REWRITE **Rewrite These to Make Them Neutral**

1. The delay is very annoying.

1. Everyone MUST check the new files today!

1. I think the system is acting strange again.

1. Sorry everyone, but the meeting is suddenly cancelled.

 REWRITE **Improve the Clarity**

Rewrite each notice so it is clearer and more professional.

Make each one more useful by adding:

- the real topic
- the key fact
- the effect or next step

1. The meeting will change.

1. There is something wrong with the file.

1. We are doing something with the system tomorrow.

1. The documents are not ready yet.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Write a Short Internal Notice

Situation: You are writing to colleagues in your section. A system update will occur tomorrow between 9:00-12:00. Users may not be able to access certain functions.

Write a short internal notice. Include:

- Heading:
- Background:
- Essential information:
- Next step:

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Two Notices

Choose two situations and write two internal notices for colleagues inside your organisation.

- A. A scheduled meeting time has changed for your team.
- B. A new internal rule will begin next month in your department.
- C. An external office will conduct a short audit next week at your section.
- D. Monthly reports will be reviewed later than usual this month.

For each notice, include a clear heading, short background, essential information, and a neutral next-step line.

Notice 1

Notice 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

Original

Notice

There is a problem with the files today. Please be careful. More later.



Strengthen the Notice

Rewrite this weak internal notice as a clearer one. Give it a specific heading, explain the real issue, and make the next step clear.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Self-Check

After you write your notices in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Is the topic clear?
- ☐ Is the language factual, not emotional?
- ☐ Does the message tell the reader what happens next?
- ☐ Is the notice short but complete?



Reflect on This Unit

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. What makes a notice effective or ineffective?
2. Which part of the notice structure is most difficult for you?

3. Which notice from Activity E is clearer? Why?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

WRITE Real-World Notice Transfer

Use one of these sources:

- one notice you wrote in Activity E
- a real internal notice in English or Japanese

Rewrite or expand it as a fuller internal bulletin for colleagues.

- a clear heading
- brief background
- essential information
- impact if needed
- a neutral next step

If you use your own Activity E notice, add at least two new supporting sentences.

10

Explaining Problems Clearly

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- explain a workplace problem in clear neutral language.
- include the main parts of a problem explanation in a logical way.
- write a short explanation of a problem or issue.

A. WARM-UP

 NOTICE Identify the Missing Information

Read the sentences. Write one question the reader may still have.

1. The system isn't working.

2. There is a problem with the file.

3. The review is delayed.

4. We cannot access the document.

 LEARN Problem Explanation Basics

A good problem explanation tells the reader what was expected, what went wrong, what effect this has, and what is happening now. It is not a request or a complaint. It gives neutral information.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Version A

The system isn't working.

Version B

Reviewers cannot access the file system this morning because the server is temporarily unavailable. The document review is delayed, and the IT team is checking the issue now.

**Why This Works**

Version B helps because it gives the issue, the cause, the effect, and the current status. Professional readers often need this information before they can decide what to do next.

C. LANGUAGE

**Useful Problem-Explanation Phrases****Describing the Issue**

- There is an issue with...
- We found a problem in...
- The system is not responding.
- The file cannot be opened.

Describing the Cause (if known)

- due to a system error
- because the file format is incorrect
- due to missing information
- because the server is temporarily unavailable

Describing the Effect

- This may affect the schedule.
- This has delayed the review.
- Users may not be able to access...
- The examination cannot continue at this stage.

Describing the Current Status

- The issue is being reviewed.
- The file is currently under inspection.
- A temporary solution is being used.
- Further updates will be provided.

**Improve the Explanation**

Rewrite each message to make it clearer and more complete.

Try to make the reader understand:

- what the problem is
- what caused it
- what happens next

1. There is a problem with the file.

1. The system is slow.

1. We can't finish the work.

1. The document is wrong.

 **REWRITE** **Add Details**

Add **two additional sentences** to explain the situation more clearly.

The added sentences should not repeat the first line. Use them to give:

- one useful cause, fact, or example
- one effect, status, or next-step detail

1. The application cannot be opened.

1. The review is delayed.

-
1. The uploaded form is incomplete.
-
-

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Write a Problem Explanation

Read the situation and facts. Then write a short problem explanation of **4-5 sentences**.

Situation: You are updating your supervisor about a system error.

Facts:

- Reviewers cannot access several files.
- The error started this morning.
- The IT team says the issue may be connected to yesterday's server update.
- The review schedule may be delayed.
- IT is checking the system now.

Include:

- the issue
 - the possible cause
 - the effect on work
 - the current status
-
-
-
-
-
-
-
-
-

E. FREER PRACTICE

WRITE Write Two Problem Explanations

Choose two situations and write clear explanations of **4-5 sentences each**. For each one, write for a supervisor or colleague who needs clear factual information.

- A. A deadline must be moved because information is missing.
- B. A document uploaded by an applicant is corrupted.
- C. Two systems are giving different results.
- D. A shared drive is not accessible this morning.

In each explanation, include the issue, the effect, and the current status. Add the cause if it is known.

Explanation 1

Explanation 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

Original

There is a problem with the database. We cannot continue some work. Something is different in the uploaded files. Maybe more information will come later.



Repair the Problem Logic

Rewrite this explanation so it is clearer and better organized. Include the issue, effect, and current status.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Self-Check

After you write your explanations in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Did I state the issue clearly?
- ☐ Did I add the cause if it is known?
- ☐ Did I explain the effect on work or schedule?
- ☐ Did I tell the reader the current status?



Reflect on This Unit

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. What makes a problem explanation clear or unclear?
2. Which part of the structure is easiest for you?
3. Which part is most difficult?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION



Real-World Problem Update

Use one of these sources:

- one problem from your workplace
- one unclear problem message from email or conversation
- one Unit 10 freer-practice scenario

Write a short **5-6 sentence** update for a manager or colleague who needs clear factual information.

Include:

- background
- issue
- effect
- current status

Keep the tone factual and neutral.

11

Writing Simple Meeting Summaries

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify the key information that belongs in a meeting summary.
- write a short meeting summary using clear neutral language.
- record decisions and next steps from a meeting.

A. WARM-UP

Read both summaries. Which summary is clearer and more useful for a colleague who missed the meeting? Give two reasons.

Summary A

We talked about many things. Some documents were mentioned. IT will do something with the system. We will meet again.

Summary B

The team reviewed the preparation checklist. Two items still require confirmation: the applicant list and the updated guidelines. IT will confirm system access on Monday. The next meeting will be held on Wednesday.



LEARN

Meeting Summary Basics

A meeting summary is a brief record of important points from a meeting. It highlights key information, records decisions, and notes action items. It does not include personal opinions or long explanations.



LEARN

A Useful Meeting Summary

A useful meeting summary records only the important points, separates decisions from general discussion, and tells the reader what happens next.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Meeting Summary Example

Meeting Summary - Review Preparation Meeting

The team discussed the schedule for next week's review. Two documents still require confirmation from the external office. The IT team will prepare access to the shared folder by Monday. A follow-up meeting is planned for Wednesday.



LEARN

Why Summary B Works Better

Summary B is stronger because it groups the meeting content by function:

- what the meeting was about
- what issues matter
- what happens next

Summary A feels weak because it uses vague words like many things and something. A meeting summary is not a story of everything that happened; it is a practical record for a reader who needs the important points quickly.

C. LANGUAGE



STRUCTURE

Key Elements of a Meeting Summary

A Clear Summary Usually Includes

- topic / purpose of the meeting
- main points discussed
- decisions made
- next steps / action items

Useful Phrases

- The team discussed...
- It was agreed that...
- The following issues were raised...
- The next meeting will be...
- The team will...



NOTICE

Identify the Elements

Label each sentence with: **T = Topic, M = Main point, D = Decision, A = Action item.**

1. The meeting was held to review the new application guidelines. (____)
2. The team agreed to extend the internal checking period. (____)
3. Several unclear sections in the guidelines were identified. (____)
4. A revised draft will be shared on Friday. (____)

 Improve the Clarity

Rewrite each summary to make it clearer.

1. We talked about some documents. IT will do something.

1. The meeting was long. Many ideas were shared. We will do more later.

1. The form was discussed. Someone needs to fix it.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

 Write a Short Meeting Summary

Read the meeting notes. Then write a short summary of **4-5 sentences** for a colleague who missed the meeting.

Meeting notes:

- Topic: April schedule
- Two tasks need more time.
- IT must finish a system update before the review.
- The next meeting is planned for next Tuesday.

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Two Summaries

Choose two situations and write meeting summaries of **4-5 sentences each**. For each one, write for a colleague or supervisor who needs a short internal record of the meeting.

- A. Discussion about unclear instructions in a new form.
- B. Planning meeting for the next internal audit.
- C. Review of applicant files before submission.
- D. Discussion about solving a system access issue.

Include the topic, the main point or decision, and one next step in each summary.

Summary 1

Summary 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

EDIT **Make the Summary Usable**

Rewrite the summary so it becomes clearer for a colleague who missed the meeting.

Original Summary

We talked about the forms and some schedule issues. IT also said something about access. More discussion will happen later.

{{PH-2: U11-editing-rewrite | rows=6}} :::

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

EDIT **Final Self-Check**

After you write your summaries in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Did I name the meeting topic?
- ☐ Did I include the main point or decision?
- ☐ Did I add one next step?
- ☐ Did I remove unnecessary detail?

WRITE **Reflect on This Unit**

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. What part of meeting summaries is easiest for you?
2. What part is the most difficult?
3. Which phrase from this unit will you use in your work?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

REVISE **Real-World Summary Transfer**

Use one of these sources:

- one summary you wrote in this unit
- a real meeting you attended this week
- one Unit 11 freer-practice scenario

Write a short **5-6 sentence** meeting summary for a manager or colleague who needs a clear internal record.

Make sure the summary includes:

- the meeting topic
- the main point or decision
- one action item or next step

If you revise one of your own summaries, make the key point and next step easier to see.

Module 3 Review Workshop

KEY LESSONS TO KEEP



LEARN

Core Takeaways

- Unit 8: A procedure succeeds when each step is visible, ordered, and easy for a new reader to follow.
- Unit 9: A notice works when it explains the change, the reason, and what happens next.
- Unit 10: A problem explanation becomes more useful when it separates the problem, cause, effect, and current action.
- Unit 11: A meeting summary should help future action, not simply repeat the meeting in time order.

READER-PURPOSE COMPARISON

Read these two short summaries. Decide which version better helps the reader understand the purpose, main issue, and next action.

Version A

We had a meeting on Monday. Many things were discussed. The team talked about the new system, some delays, and several questions. Another meeting may be needed.

Version B

The team met on Monday to review the new system schedule. The main issue was a document delay from one office. We agreed to request the missing file by Wednesday. A follow-up meeting will be held only if the file does not arrive.



WRITE

Review Response

Write **2-3 sentences** explaining which version is stronger. Mention reader purpose, order, and next action.

REVISION LAB

Weak Notice

The office will use a different room next week. There were some schedule problems and some people may need to move. Please understand.



Improve the Internal Notice

Rewrite the weak notice so it names the change, gives the reason, and tells the reader what action to take.

SELF-EDIT ROUTINE



Check and Revise One Internal Text

Choose one procedure, notice, problem note, or summary from this module. Use the checklist, then revise the weakest part of the text.

- ☐ Number each action or idea if order matters.
- ☐ Check whether the reason for the message appears early enough.
- ☐ Underline the sentence that tells the reader what happens next.
- ☐ Remove one vague sentence and replace it with a factual one.
- ☐ Ask: if a new staff member reads this text, will they know what to do?

Revised sentence or step

Revised text section

TRANSFER TASK



Build an Internal Communication Pack

Write a short internal communication pack about one small workplace issue such as a room change, a software problem, or a meeting follow-up.

Include:

- a 3-4 step procedure or action list
- a short notice or explanation paragraph
- a 4-5 sentence summary of the outcome or next step

Procedure

Notice

Summary

After writing, add three short notes:

1. Which part was hardest to organise?
 2. Which part needed the clearest next-step sentence?
 3. Which unit gave you the most useful support?
-
-
-
-

PREPARATION FOR MODULE 4



Ready for External Communication?

Before you start the external communication module, check whether you can do these four things without help:

- ☐ write ordered steps for a simple procedure
- ☐ explain a change with a clear reason and action
- ☐ describe a problem by separating problem, cause, effect, and response
- ☐ finish a summary with a visible next step

If one of these still feels weak, return to the unit that teaches it and revise one more internal text before moving on.

MODULE 4. Communicating with Applicants & Foreign Offices

Module Guide

Module 4 moves from internal writing to communication with readers outside your team. In this module, the writing must stay simple, but it must also give enough explanation because the reader may not share your background knowledge. These units focus on sequence, explanation, clarification, and consistency when the reader cannot easily ask you for help in person.

The four units address the challenges of outward-facing and reader-specific communication:

- Unit 12 develops external inquiries — short, clear emails that ask an answerable question of a reader outside the team.
- Unit 13 focuses on providing simple explanations — giving information to a reader who may not share the same background knowledge as the writer.
- Unit 14 addresses responding to confusion — correcting a misunderstanding or answering a follow-up question without sounding defensive.
- Unit 15 develops consistency across email communication — maintaining one clear standard when multiple people write about the same topic.

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

- write a clear external inquiry that asks answerable questions
- explain information in a way an outside or less-informed reader can follow
- respond to confusion without sounding defensive
- maintain one consistent email standard across repeated communication

Use each part of this module to help your writing:

- notice how the example versions change for audience, not only for grammar
- pay attention to the “Why this works” notes about reader confidence and clarity
- use the self-check to confirm that your message is answerable and well sequenced
- complete the editing practice so you can repair weak reader focus
- use the transfer extension to move the unit skill into a related external or team context

12

Writing Simple External Inquiries

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- write a short external inquiry email with a clear question.
- provide enough background for another office to understand my question.
- use polite inquiry phrases in a professional way.

A. WARM-UP

Read both emails. Which inquiry is more appropriate and more answerable for an outside reader? Give two reasons.

Email A

Subject: Question
Hi,
I don't understand the guidelines. Please explain.

Email B

Subject: Question About Guidelines - Section 4
Dear Team,
We are reviewing the updated guidelines and have one question about Section 4. Could you clarify how the new rule applies to applications submitted earlier this year?
Thank you.



External Inquiry Basics

A **clarification** is information that makes an unclear point clear. An external inquiry is a polite email sent to another organisation to ask for information or clarification. It should give enough background for the reader and ask one clear question.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Inquiry Email Example

Subject: Inquiry Regarding Updated Application Guidelines
Dear Review Office Team,

We are reviewing the updated guidelines and have a question about Section 4. Could you clarify whether the new requirement applies to applicants who submitted forms before March?

Further information will help us complete our internal checks.

Thank you.



Why This Works

Email B and the example email work because the outside reader gets enough background, one clear question, and a polite tone. External readers do not share all of your office context, so a strong inquiry gives enough background to answer the question without hiding the main point.

C. LANGUAGE



Structure of an External Inquiry

A Clear Inquiry Email Usually Includes

1. **subject line** - clear and specific
2. **greeting** - polite and neutral
3. **background** - brief context so the reader understands the question
4. **inquiry question** - one clear, specific question
5. **closing sentence** - neutral and polite
6. **sign-off**

Useful Phrases

- We are currently reviewing...
- Our office is checking...
- We have a question regarding...
- Could you clarify...?
- Would you be able to confirm...?
- Could you provide more information about...?
- Thank you for your assistance.
- Further information will help us complete our review.



Improve the Inquiry

Rewrite each inquiry to make it clearer, more polite, and more complete. Add a short background clue, ask one specific question, and avoid sounding demanding.

1. I don't understand this part. Tell me.

1. What is the rule?

1. When is the deadline?

1. Explain Section 2.



Add Background Information

Add **one sentence of background** before each question. The background should tell the reader what document, message, or rule you are asking about.

1. Could you clarify the new ID requirement?

1. Could you confirm the review schedule?

1. Could you explain how the updated rule applies?

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

WRITE Write an External Inquiry Email

Read the situation. Then write a complete inquiry email.

Situation: Your office received updated instructions from another office, but the explanation of the new submission process is unclear. You are writing to that external office for clarification.

Include a specific subject line, polite greeting, brief background, one clear question, and a polite closing.

E. FREER PRACTICE

WRITE Write Two External Inquiry Emails

Choose two situations below. For each one, write a short email from your office to another office or organisation that can answer the question in **3-4 sentences**.

- A. You need clarification about a new applicant requirement.
- B. Two different documents give different deadlines.
- C. You have a question about the correct version of a form.
- D. You need confirmation about the schedule for an external audit.

Include a specific subject line, brief background, one clear question, and a polite closing in each email.

Inquiry Email 1

Inquiry Email 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

Original

Subject: Question
Hi,
We do not understand this and need help. Please
explain the rule.



Make the Inquiry Answerable

Rewrite this inquiry so the outside reader can answer it more easily.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

Final Self-Check

After you write your inquiry emails in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Did I give enough background for the outside reader?
- ☐ Is the question specific?
- ☐ Did I avoid unnecessary office detail?
- ☐ Does the closing sound polite and professional?

Reflect on This Unit

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which part of your inquiry helps the outside reader answer quickly: the background, the question, or the closing?
2. What detail made the biggest difference to answerability?
3. Which question phrase fits best when the reader is an outside office?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

Internal Note Before the Inquiry

Choose one inquiry from this unit. Write a short internal note for your team explaining what is unclear, why an inquiry is needed, and what answer you hope to receive.



Homework Task

Find a real external instruction or notice. Write an inquiry email asking one clear question about it.

If you do not want to use a real instruction or notice, choose one Unit 12 freer-practice situation and write the inquiry email for that case instead.

13

Providing Simple Explanations

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- explain a process or issue in simple professional language.
- add the right amount of background and reason information.
- write a short explanatory text about a workplace issue.

A. WARM-UP

 NOTICE What Information Is Missing?

Read each explanation. Write what information the reader still needs.

1. The schedule changed.

2. The form is incorrect.

3. The applicant information is different.

4. The process will take longer.

 LEARN Simple Explanation Basics

A simple explanation helps the reader understand the situation, the reason, and the effect on the work. It gives enough information to follow the point, but it does not add unnecessary technical detail.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Version A

The process will take longer.

Version B

The process will take longer because two documents require additional checking. This means the next review stage will begin later than planned.



LEARN

Why This Works

Version B gives the situation, the reason, and the effect. The reader does not need to guess the practical meaning.

C. LANGUAGE



STRUCTURE

Useful Phrases for Explanations**Giving Background**

- The purpose of this process is...
- This procedure is used when...
- This step is required because...

Explaining the Reason

- because...
- due to...
- as a result of...

Giving Additional Information

- This means that...
- In this case...
- For this reason...

A useful explanation usually moves from background to reason to effect. If one part is missing, the explanation may sound incomplete even when the grammar is correct.



REWRITE

Improve the Explanation

Rewrite each sentence to make the explanation clearer. Build each answer so the reader can understand what happened, why it happened, and why it matters.

1. The schedule changed.

1. The file is wrong.

1. The review will take longer.

1. The system is slow.



Add a Reason or Background

Add **one sentence of background** and **one sentence of reason** before each main sentence.

1. The applicant list is incomplete.

1. The document cannot be accepted.

1. The review must be rescheduled.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Write a Clear Explanation

Read the situation and facts. Then write a clear explanation of **4-5 sentences**.

Situation: You are explaining the situation to a colleague or supervisor.

Facts:

- A document cannot be reviewed.
- The attached files do not match the information in the system.
- The correct version must be confirmed before the next review stage.
- The review may take longer than planned.
- Your team is now confirming which file version is correct.

Include background, issue, reason, effect, and current status.

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Two Explanations

Choose two situations and write explanations. For each one, write a short internal explanation for a colleague or supervisor who needs a clear update.

- The applicant used an old version of the form.
- A system update changed the display order of documents.
- A reviewer found inconsistent information in two files.
- A required field was left blank.

Include background, the main issue, and the reason or effect in each explanation.

Explanation 1

Explanation 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

Original

The document cannot be accepted. There is a problem with one section. The process will change.



Add the Missing Link

Rewrite this explanation so the reader can see both the reason and the effect.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Self-Check

After you write your explanations in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Did I give enough background?
- ☐ Did I explain the reason clearly?
- ☐ Did I show the effect on work or timing?
- ☐ Is the explanation neutral and easy to follow?



Reflect on This Unit

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which link in your explanation is still weakest: background, reason, or effect?
2. Which detail would help a new colleague understand the situation fastest?
3. Which phrase from this unit is most useful for making an explanation easier to follow?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION



Explanation for Two Readers

Choose one explanation from this unit. Rewrite it twice: once for a colleague and once for a supervisor. Keep the facts the same, but decide how much detail each reader needs.

For a colleague

For a supervisor



Homework Task

Find a real explanation you wrote or received. Rewrite it using the structure from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real explanation, choose one Unit 13 freer-practice situation and write the explanation for that case instead.

14

Responding to Confusion

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- acknowledge confusion politely in writing.
- restate the correct information clearly.
- add one useful detail without blaming the reader.
- write a short response that corrects a misunderstanding.

A. WARM-UP

**What Is the Confusion?**

Read each sentence. Write the point the reader is confused about.

1. I thought the deadline was next Monday.

2. This form looks different from the one I used last year.

3. I am not sure which file I should upload.

4. The instructions seem to say two different things.

**Responding to Confusion Basics**

When a reader is confused, the response should make the unclear point clear. A good response acknowledges the question, gives the correct information, adds one useful detail if needed, and avoids blaming language.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Clarification Response Example

Thank you for your question. To clarify, the updated instructions apply only to applications submitted after 1 June. Applications from earlier months will follow the previous procedure. I hope this resolves the confusion.

LEARN Why This Works

The response acknowledges the question, gives the correct information, and adds the detail the reader needs. It corrects the misunderstanding without blaming the reader.

C. LANGUAGE

STRUCTURE Useful Phrases to Clarify Information

Acknowledging the Question

- Thank you for your question.
- Thank you for checking.
- I understand why this point may be unclear.

Restating the Correct Information

- To clarify...
- The correct information is...
- The updated requirement is...

Adding One Useful Detail

- This applies only to...
- In this case...
- One important point is...

A clarification response should stay focused on solving the confusion. It should not turn into a complaint about the reader's mistake.

REWRITE Improve the Response

Rewrite each response so it is clear and polite. When possible, acknowledge the confusion, state the correct information, and add the next useful detail.

1. No, that is wrong.

1. You misunderstood the instructions.

1. The other form is for something else.

1. Read the guidelines again.



REWRITE

Add Clarifying Information

Add **one sentence that acknowledges the confusion** and **one sentence that clarifies**.

1. The applicant uploaded the wrong file.

1. The deadline mentioned in the email is incorrect.

1. The instructions refer to two different processes.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

WRITE Write a Clarification Response

Read the situation. Then write a clear, polite response of **4-5 sentences**.

Situation: A colleague thinks all documents must be submitted this Friday, but only two documents are required by that date.

Your response should acknowledge the confusion, state the correct information, and add one useful detail about the remaining documents.

E. FREER PRACTICE

WRITE Write Two Clarification Responses

Choose two situations and write a short response for each one.

- A. A reviewer believes the system error has been fixed, but it is still under investigation.
- B. A colleague thinks an applicant must redo the entire form, but only one page is incorrect.
- C. Someone believes the new rule applies to all departments, but it applies only to one team.
- D. A colleague misunderstood the meeting location.

In each response, acknowledge the confusion, state the correct information, and add one useful detail.

Response 1

Response 2**F. EDITING PRACTICE****Remove the Defensive Tone**

Rewrite the response so it becomes clearer and more professional.

Original Response

You misunderstood the message. We already explained this rule before, so please read it again carefully.

{{PH-2: U14-editing-rewrite | rows=6}} :::

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION**Final Self-Check**

After you write your responses in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Did I acknowledge the confusion politely?
- ☐ Did I restate the correct information clearly?
- ☐ Did I add one useful detail?

☐ Did I avoid blame?

 WRITE Reflect on This Unit

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which move matters most when responding to confusion: acknowledging the question, restating the fact, or adding one clarifying detail? Why?
2. Where did you need to reduce blame or defensiveness most carefully?
3. How would your response change if the reader were a colleague instead of an outside contact?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 WRITE Clarification for a Team Record

Choose one misunderstanding from this unit. Write a short internal record explaining what the confusion was, what the correct information is, and what staff should remember next time.

 WRITE Homework Task

Find an unclear message from a real situation. Write a clear, polite response to correct the misunderstanding.

If you do not want to use a real situation, choose one Unit 14 freer-practice option and write the response for that case instead.

15

Maintaining Consistent Email Style

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify inconsistency in an email's tone, structure, or formatting.
- rewrite an email to match a consistent professional style.
- write short emails that follow a standard structure.
- explain why consistent email style matters for a team.

A. WARM-UP

**NOTICE Identify the Inconsistencies**

Read the two emails. Decide what is inconsistent in Email A.

Email A

Subject: Info

Hi,

I saw it. What next?

Thx.

Email B

Subject: Information Required for Review

Dear Team,

We reviewed the application this morning and need confirmation about the submission date. Could you clarify this point?

Thank you.

What is inconsistent in Email A? Think about tone, clarity, formatting, and email parts.

**LEARN Email Consistency Basics**

A consistent email uses the same basic style from start to finish. The subject line, greeting, purpose sentence, body, closing, and sign-off should all feel like parts of the same professional message.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Version A

Subject: File
Hi, I checked it. Please tell me what to do. Thanks.

Version B

Subject: Question About Document Review
Dear Team,
I reviewed the document and found that two sections
require additional information. Could you clarify the
details for Section 3?
Thank you.



LEARN

Why This Works

The consistent version has a clear subject line, professional greeting, complete purpose sentence, polite question, and simple closing. Each part supports the same professional style.

C. LANGUAGE



STRUCTURE

Standard Email Elements

Use standard email elements to create consistency.

Email element	Useful language
Greeting	Dear Mr./Ms. [Name], / Dear Team,
Opening	Thank you for your email. / I am writing to...
Purpose	I would like to confirm... / We have a question regarding...
Request or detail	Could you clarify...? / Please let me know...
Closing	Thank you. / Kind regards,



REWRITE

Improve Consistency

Rewrite each email so the tone and structure are consistent.

- Hi, I checked it. What should I do now?

- Hello, Please check. I think there is a problem.

1. Team, The file is wrong. Fix it.

Original

Subject: Question
hi,
I looked at the file. some dates are not same. can you
check fast.
thanks



Reformat the Email

Rewrite the email so the subject line, greeting, body, and closing follow one professional style.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Standardize a Draft Email

Rewrite the email so the subject line, greeting, body, request, closing, and sign-off work together in one consistent style.

Original Draft Email

Subject: Check
Hello,
The file arrived. I need you to look again. It has missing
things and some other problem. Can you send it?

Thanks.



REWRITE

Write your revised email here

E. FREER PRACTICE



WRITE

Write Two Consistent Emails

Choose two situations. For each one, write a short email with a clear subject line, greeting, purpose sentence, body, request or next step, and closing.

- A. Ask a colleague to confirm a missing date in a document.
- B. Ask an applicant to resend a form with one missing page.
- C. Tell a team member that a file name needs to be corrected.
- D. Ask a supervisor to confirm which version of a guideline should be used.

Email 1

Email 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Bring Two Drafts to One Standard

Rewrite each draft so both messages use the same professional style.

1. Hi, file is wrong. fix?

1. Dear Ms. Lee, There is problem in form. send again please. Thanks.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Self-Check

After you write your emails in Activity E and complete the editing practice in Activity F, check your work again:

- ☐ Does each email have a clear subject line?
- ☐ Do the greeting, body, and closing match in tone?
- ☐ Is each request polite and specific?
- ☐ Is the formatting easy to scan?

**Reflect on This Unit**

Answer the questions in short notes.

1. Which part of an email is easiest for you to keep consistent?
2. Which part needs more attention: subject line, greeting, body, request, or closing?
3. Which standard phrase from this unit could your team use regularly?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

**Mini Team Style Rules**

Write three simple style rules your team could use for similar emails. Then choose one Activity E email and revise it so it follows those rules.

Team style rules

Revised email



Homework Task

Find a real short email or message that feels inconsistent in tone or format. Rewrite it using one consistent professional style.

If you do not want to use a real message, choose one Unit 15 freer-practice situation and write the email for that case instead.

Module 4 Review Workshop

KEY LESSONS TO KEEP



LEARN

Core Takeaways

- Unit 12: An inquiry helps the reader reply when the background is short, the question is specific, and the tone is respectful.
- Unit 13: An explanation becomes easier to follow when details are grouped and connected instead of piled together.
- Unit 14: A clarification response is stronger when it restates the point, answers it clearly, and avoids defensive language.
- Unit 15: Consistency gives the reader confidence because repeated messages follow a stable pattern.

AUDIENCE-CONTROL COMPARISON

Read these two openings. Decide which version is easier for the reader to answer.

Version A

I am writing because there are some things we do not understand and we want more information about the process you explained before.

Version B

I am writing to ask for clarification about the document submission process described in your previous email.



WRITE

Review Response

Write **2-3 sentences** explaining which version is stronger. Mention audience, amount of detail, and answerability.

REVISION LAB

Weak Response

You misunderstood the process. We already explained it before, so please read the instructions again and follow them correctly.



Improve the Reader Response

Rewrite the weak response so it explains the process clearly, removes blame language, and gives the reader a clear way forward.

SELF-EDIT ROUTINE



Check and Revise One External Message

Choose one inquiry, explanation, clarification response, or repeated email from Units 12-15. Use the checklist, then revise the weakest part of the message.

- ☐ Can the reader see the purpose in the first one or two sentences?
- ☐ Does the message explain only the background that the reader needs?
- ☐ Is each question or explanation point easy to answer or follow?
- ☐ If the reader was confused before, does the response sound helpful rather than defensive?
- ☐ Does the message follow the same style rules used elsewhere in the module?

Revised opening or question

Revised message section

TRANSFER TASK**Write for Two Readers**

Create a short two-part communication set about one administrative issue such as a missing document, a confusing instruction, or an inconsistent email pattern.

Write:

- one short outward-facing email to the person or office involved
- one short internal explanation for your team

Your outward-facing email should include a clear purpose, only the detail the reader needs, and a respectful closing.

Outward-Facing Email

Internal Explanation

After writing, add three short notes:

1. How did the audience change your wording?
2. How did you control the amount of detail?
3. Which unit strategy helped you keep the writing consistent?

PREPARATION FOR MODULE 5



Ready for Editing Practice?

Before you start the editing module, check whether you can do these four things without help:

- ☐ write a respectful, answerable inquiry
- ☐ explain details in grouped, connected sentences
- ☐ answer confusion without sounding defensive
- ☐ keep repeated messages consistent in style

If one of these still feels weak, return to the unit that teaches it and revise one more external message before moving on.

MODULE 5. Editing & Revision Skills (Basic)

Module Guide

Module 5 shifts your role from writer to editor. In this module, you do not only find mistakes. You also learn what each revision does for the reader. The units help you check accuracy, clarity, and tone separately, and then use them together to improve a real workplace draft.

The three units address accuracy, clarity, and tone as separate editing skills:

- Unit 16 develops editing for accuracy — identifying and correcting common grammar and information errors in workplace drafts.
- Unit 17 develops editing for clarity — revising vague, overloaded, or poorly ordered text so the reader can follow the message more easily.
- Unit 18 develops editing for tone — changing how a message sounds without changing what it says.

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

- identify and correct common accuracy problems
- revise vague or overloaded writing into clearer messages
- change tone without changing the main meaning
- explain revision choices in simple professional language

Use each part of this module in this order:

- compare the weak and strong versions first
- read the explanation of why the revised version helps the reader
- use the self-check before freer practice
- complete the editing practice so you explain the revision, not only produce it
- use the transfer extension to turn the editing skill into a repeatable workplace habit

16

Editing for Accuracy

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify basic grammar and accuracy problems in workplace writing.
- correct common errors in short administrative texts.
- revise a short email for more accurate language use.
- edit a short paragraph for accuracy and clarity.

A. WARM-UP

 EDIT **Spot the Errors**

Correct the mistakes in each sentence.

1. *The applicant have submit the form yesterday.*
2. *Please confirm the informations.*
3. *We checking the files now.*
4. *The review start next week.*

 LEARN **Quick Accuracy Check**

- Is the verb form correct?
- Are singular and plural forms correct?
- Does the sentence need an article or preposition?
- Is the punctuation clear?

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Compare the two versions.

Sentence A

The applicant have submit the form yesterday.

Sentence B

The applicant submitted the form yesterday.



LEARN

Why This Works

Sentence B works because the reader does not need to stop and repair the grammar mentally.

Accuracy matters in administrative writing because errors can create:

- confusion about time
- confusion about quantity
- confusion about responsibility

Accurate writing is not only a language goal. It is also a workplace clarity goal.

A small grammar error can become a workplace problem when it changes:

- who must act
- when something happens
- what quantity or document is correct

Mini contrast - Weak: "The documents is complete."

Stronger: "The documents are complete."

One small change can stop the reader from doubting the message.

C. LANGUAGE



LANGUAGE

What Accuracy Means in Writing

Accuracy means using language correctly so the reader does not have to guess the meaning.

Check these main areas:

- grammar
- spelling
- verb tense
- articles
- prepositions
- basic punctuation

Accurate writing is easier to understand and helps prevent mistakes in workplace processes.



Common Accuracy Problems

Verb Forms

- We **reviewed** the file yesterday. (past)
- We **are reviewing** the file now. (present continuous)

Articles

- The file is in **the** shared folder.
- Please attach **a** document.

Prepositions

- The meeting is **on** Monday.
- The update will be available **after** 3 p.m.



Editing Principle

When you edit for accuracy, check one error family at a time:

1. verb form
2. article / plural
3. preposition
4. punctuation

This makes editing more reliable than trying to fix everything at once.



Practice A: Correct the Sentences

Rewrite each sentence correctly.

Work in a fixed order:

1. find the main grammar problem
2. correct the key word or phrase
3. reread the full sentence for meaning

Accuracy check:

- ☐ Does the sentence now sound complete?
- ☐ Does the time reference make sense?
- ☐ Does the noun or verb form match the message?

1. *The system under maintenance today.*

1. *We will checking the documents.*

1. *Please send me informations about new procedure.*

1. *The documents is complete.*



Practice B: Edit for Accuracy

Each short text contains 4-5 errors. Rewrite the corrected version.

Text 1

The file are not complete. We need to check it again before send it to the next team. The applicant not submit the correct form.

Text 2

We reviewing the documents now. There is many missings informations. Please confirm us the deadline.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Edit a Short Administrative Email

You are editing a short email draft before it is sent to a colleague or applicant.

Rewrite the corrected, professional version.

Original Email

Subject: Form
Hi,
I check the document yesterday and it have some mistake. The informations in section 2 is not correct and applicant no submit the signature. Please fix it. Thank you.

{{PH-3: U16-guided-document | rows=10}} :::

E. FREER PRACTICE



Edit Two Short Texts

Choose two situations. For each one, read the short draft and rewrite it so the final version is accurate and ready to use.

- A. Status update

We check the file yesterday and find two missing pages. The review continue tomorrow after the team receive the complete copy.

- B. Filing problem

The signed form is in wrong folder and one attachment is missing from package. Please look at record in shared drive and move it to correct case file.

- C. Request email

Dear Team, We needs the updated checklist before Friday. Could you send it after you review the last version?

- D. Meeting summary

The team discuss the schedule this morning and decide the next review happen on Wednesday. Ms. Tanaka prepare the revised file and Mr. Lee send the notice later.

Keep the original meaning, but correct the language so the final version is accurate and usable.

Version 1

Version 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

**Explain the Change**

Choose two corrections from your work in this unit.

For each one, explain:

- ☐ what the original error was
- ☐ why the corrected version is better
- ☐ what you should check next time

Correction 1

Correction 2

Original

The review process start tomorrow. The team are preparing the documents now. There is some informations missing from applicant. We checking the system also. The final schedule will share later. This may affect the next steps.



Edit a Paragraph

Rewrite this paragraph (6-8 sentences) to correct errors and improve clarity. Treat it as a draft internal update that needs editing before your team shares it.

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Accuracy Check Before You Finish

After you complete Activities E and F, check your work again:

- ☐ Is the time clear?
- ☐ Are singular and plural forms correct?
- ☐ Are the articles and prepositions correct?
- ☐ Does the corrected version sound natural enough to send?

**Reflect on This Unit**

1. Which accuracy problem still slows your editing most: verb form, article/plural control, prepositions, or punctuation? Explain why.
2. Which correction in your work changed the meaning or clarity most clearly for the reader?
3. What check should come first in your own editing routine next time, and why?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

**Accuracy Review Routine**

Write a short editing routine of 4-5 lines for yourself.

For example:

- first check verb forms
- then check plural / article use
- then check prepositions
- then read once for punctuation

Use your own wording, but make it a routine you could really use at work.



Homework Task

Find one email or document you wrote recently. Edit it for accuracy using the skills from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real email or document, choose one Unit 16 freer-practice situation and edit that text instead.

17

Editing for Clarity

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify vague or unclear language in workplace writing.
- rewrite sentences to make them clearer and more direct.
- reorganize information for better logical flow.
- revise a paragraph so it is easier to understand.

A. WARM-UP

**NOTICE** What Makes These Sentences Unclear?

Identify the main problem in each sentence.

1. It looks like maybe there is something wrong with the form in some places.
2. We think the system might not be working correctly for some users.
3. There are many things to check so it will maybe take a bit longer.
4. The information is kind of different from the last version.

**LEARN** Quick Clarity Check

- remove vague words
- keep the main point early
- use a logical order
- cut extra words that do not help the reader

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Compare the two versions.

Version A

The review was delayed. There is missing information.
The new schedule will be announced tomorrow. The original deadline was Friday.

Version B

The review was delayed because some information is missing. A new schedule will be announced tomorrow.



Why This Works

Version B works because the reader can see the relationship between the ideas.

Clarity editing is not only “make it shorter.” It is also:

- remove vague words
- show the main point earlier
- put related ideas together

C. LANGUAGE



What Clarity Means in Writing

Clarity means that the reader can understand your message quickly and correctly.

Clear writing:

- uses direct language
- avoids long or complicated sentences
- presents ideas in a logical order
- avoids vague or ambiguous wording

Before: The document, which was previously reviewed and looked at by two people, seems like it maybe has some missing parts.

After: The document appears to be missing some parts.



Common Clarity Problems

Vague Language

- “kind of” “maybe” “a bit” “something” “in some places”

Unnecessary Words

- The reason is because -> The reason is
- Due to the fact that -> Because

Long or Complicated Sentences

- Too many clauses
- Unclear subject or action

When you edit for clarity, ask:

- Who is doing the action?
- What is the main point?
- Which detail can move later or be deleted?

Mini contrast - Weak: "There is something about the file that may cause a kind of delay."

Stronger: "The file is missing two pages, so the next review step will be delayed."

 REWRITE **Practice A: Make the Sentences Clearer**

Rewrite each sentence.

1. It looks like the file maybe has a few issues.

1. There are things missing from the form somewhere.

1. We think that it could possibly be delayed for some reason.

1. It would be appreciated if you could maybe check the document again.

 REWRITE **Practice B: Reorganise for Better Flow**

Rewrite the sentences in a clear, logical order. Look for a simple movement:

1. background or first action

2. problem or finding
3. result or next effect

Sentences:

- A. Two forms are incomplete.
- B. We reviewed the applicant's file this morning.
- C. This will delay the next review stage.

Write the best order and then write one clear version.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Edit for Clarity

Rewrite the paragraph in 4-5 clear sentences. Treat it as a draft update that a colleague wrote for internal use.

Original Paragraph

The system was slow today and we couldn't do much because of it. Also, there was a problem with the files and some people couldn't open them. So the schedule might change, and maybe we will need more time. There might be more information later.

{{PH-2: U17-guided-paragraph | rows=8}} :::

E. FREER PRACTICE



Edit Two Texts for Clarity

Choose two situations. For each one, read the short draft and rewrite it so the final version is clearer, shorter, and better organized.

- A. Delay explanation

There were some things wrong with the file and because of that it seems like the review might take a bit longer, and we will maybe send the new timing later.

B. Missing documents

We checked the package and there are some missing things and it is kind of difficult to move to the next stage right now because not everything is there yet.

C. Status update

Something about the system is affecting some users, so maybe the work today is not moving in the normal way and more information will probably come later.

D. Meeting summary

We talked about the schedule, and some people said different things, and there were also some actions, so the next step is not completely clear yet.

Version 1

Version 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

EDIT From Vague to Usable

Rewrite the draft so it becomes clearer for an internal reader.

Original Draft

There were maybe some issues with the forms and things will probably take a bit longer because of that, and more information will maybe come later.

EDIT Write your revised message here

EDIT Clear Paragraph Revision

Rewrite the paragraph in 6-8 sentences to improve clarity and flow. Treat it as a draft internal paragraph that needs revision before it is shared.

Original Paragraph

We checked some things and there are maybe a few issues. The system did something unexpected. There is also something strange with the document names. So it could change the review schedule and it might take longer. More information will be available later.

EDIT Write your revised paragraph here

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



EDIT

Clarity Check Before You Finish

Before you finish, check:

- ☐ Is the main point easy to find?
- ☐ Which words are vague?
- ☐ Which sentence can be made shorter?
- ☐ Does the order help the reader follow the message?



WRITE

Reflect on This Unit

1. Which clarity problem causes the biggest reader difficulty in your writing: vagueness, wordiness, or poor order? Explain your choice.
2. Which revision strategy from this unit improved your draft most clearly, and what exactly changed?
3. When you revise for clarity, which detail should stay and which detail is usually better cut or moved?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION



WRITE

Explain Your Revision Choice

Choose one sentence you improved in this unit.

Write:

- the weak version
- the stronger version
- one line explaining why the stronger version is easier for the reader

 WRITE **Homework Task**

Choose one paragraph you wrote in a previous unit. Rewrite it for clarity using today's strategies.

18

Editing for Tone

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify tone problems such as directness, blame, or emotional language.
- soften a message without making it unclear.
- rewrite a short email in a more professional tone.
- revise a paragraph so it sounds more neutral and appropriate.

A. WARM-UP

**NOTICE** What Is Wrong with the Tone?

Identify the main tone problem in each sentence.

1. Send it now.
2. This is unacceptable.
3. Why didn't you do this?
4. Hey, please fix this ASAP.

**LEARN** Quick Tone Check

- remove blame
- avoid emotional wording
- keep the request clear
- sound calm and professional

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

Compare the two versions.

Message A

You didn't send the right file. Send the correct one now.

Message B

Thank you for your message. The attached file appears to be a different version. Could you please send the correct version when available?



LEARN

Why This Works

Message B works because it:

- removes blame
- keeps the focus on the file, not the person
- still asks clearly for the needed action

Tone editing is successful when the message stays useful and becomes easier to receive.

C. LANGUAGE



LANGUAGE

What Tone Means in Writing

Tone is how your writing sounds to the reader.

A professional tone is:

- polite
- neutral
- clear
- respectful

A poor tone may be:

- too direct
- blaming
- emotional
- too casual



LANGUAGE

Softening Direct Language

Direct -> Polite

- You didn't submit the file.
- You need to fix this.
- That is wrong.

Useful Softening Phrases

- It appears that...
- It seems that...
- There may be an issue with...
- Thank you for checking...

REWRITE Practice A: Make the Tone Polite

Rewrite the sentences politely.

Do not only add “please.” Try to soften the message by changing:

- blame to neutral description
- command to request
- harsh judgment to workable explanation

Mini contrast - Weak: “You made a mistake.”

Stronger: “There seems to be an error in the current version.”

1. This is wrong.

1. You made a mistake.

1. Check it again.

1. This is not acceptable.

LANGUAGE Tone in Emails

Emails often need polite tone markers.

Useful Email Tone Markers

- Thank you for your message.
- Thank you for letting us know.
- We appreciate your cooperation.
- Please let us know if you need further information.

Common Tone Problems

- imperatives
- emotional expressions
- blaming language



Editing Principle

When revising for tone, try this order:

1. remove blame
2. restate the issue neutrally
3. add the needed action politely
4. keep the original purpose



Practice B: Improve the Email Tone

Rewrite each short email to improve tone.

Email 1

Subject: Document You didn't attach the correct file. Attach the right one now.

Email 2

Subject: Problem Why didn't you tell me about this earlier? Now we have a delay.

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Edit a Full Email

Rewrite the email to make the tone neutral and professional. Treat it as a draft message that will be sent to an applicant or colleague after revision.

Original Email

Subject: Form
Hi,
The applicant did not follow the instructions again. This is causing problems for us. Fix the form and send it back quickly.

{{PH-3: U18-guided-document | rows=10}} :::

E. FREER PRACTICE



Write Two Tone-Improved Emails

Choose two situations. For each one, read the rough draft and rewrite it so the final email is more polite, neutral, and suitable for workplace communication.

- A. Missing information

You still didn't send the missing page. We asked before, and now this is causing a delay. Send it today.

- B. Inconsistent file set

There is a problem with your files again. You sent the wrong version, and this is making extra work for us.

- C. Delay notice

This process will take longer because your earlier message was incomplete, and now we have to check everything again.

- D. Clarifying a misunderstanding

You understood this incorrectly. Read the earlier message again and follow the correct process this time.

Email 1

Email 2

F. EDITING PRACTICE

 Keep the Meaning, Change the Tone

Rewrite the draft so it stays clear but sounds more professional.

Original Draft

You gave us the wrong information again. This is causing delays for our team. Please fix it immediately.

 Write your revised message here

**Tone Revision Paragraph**

Rewrite the paragraph in 6-8 sentences to improve tone while keeping the same information. Treat it as a draft internal note that needs a more neutral and professional tone before it is shared.

Original Paragraph

We told the applicant many times, but they still submitted the wrong file. This is very frustrating. They clearly didn't follow the instructions again. Now everything is delayed. We can't work like this. Someone needs to explain the rules again.

**Write your revised paragraph here**

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION**Tone Check Before You Finish**

Before you finish, check:

- ☐ Did I remove blame?
- ☐ Does the message still say what is needed?
- ☐ Does the tone sound calm and professional?
- ☐ Would I be comfortable sending this version?

**Reflect on This Unit**

1. Which tone problem is hardest to fix in revision: blame, pressure, emotional wording, or abruptness? Why?
2. Which softening phrase works best only when the message still stays clear and useful for the reader?

3. How should tone revision change when the reader is a colleague rather than an applicant or outside office?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

WRITE **Tone Choice for Two Readers**

Take one message from this unit and write:

1. a version for a colleague
2. a version for an outside reader

Then explain:

- what changed
- why the tone needed to change

WRITE **Homework Task**

Find one email you wrote recently. Rewrite it using the tone strategies from this unit.

If you do not want to use a real email, choose one Unit 18 freer-practice situation and rewrite it using the tone strategies from this unit instead.

Module 5 Review Workshop

KEY LESSONS TO KEEP



LEARN Core Takeaways

- Unit 16: Accuracy matters because small language errors can damage trust and force the reader to work harder.
- Unit 17: Clarity revision helps the reader understand the point faster and reduces follow-up questions.
- Unit 18: Tone revision changes how the reader feels about the message without changing the administrative meaning.

REVISION COMPARISON

Read these two versions. Decide which version better controls accuracy, clarity, and tone.

Version A

You did not send the correct file. This caused a problem again. We need you to fix it now.

Version B

The attached file does not appear to match the requested format. Could you please send the correct file today so that we can continue the review?



WRITE Review Response

Write **2-3 sentences** explaining which version is stronger. Mention accuracy, clarity, and tone.

REVISION LAB

Weak Draft

The office checked your file yesterday but there is a mistake in many parts and this creates trouble for us. You need to correct it fast because this kind of thing happens again and again.



Improve the Weak Draft

Revise the weak draft in three passes: first improve accuracy, then improve clarity, and then improve tone.

SELF-EDIT ROUTINE



Check and Revise One Earlier Draft

Choose one draft from Modules 1-4. Use the routine, then revise the weakest part of the draft.

- ☐ Accuracy pass: check grammar, word choice, and basic correctness.
- ☐ Clarity pass: shorten heavy sentences and remove vague language.
- ☐ Tone pass: check whether the message sounds cooperative and professional.
- ☐ Final pass: confirm that the revised draft still says the same essential thing.

Revised sentence or section

TRANSFER TASK



Revise One Draft Three Ways

Take one earlier draft from Modules 1-4 and revise it three times.

- Version 1: accuracy focus
- Version 2: clarity focus
- Version 3: tone focus

Version 1 (Accuracy Focus)

Version 2 (Clarity Focus)

Version 3 (Tone Focus)

Revision Notes

After revising, add three short notes:

1. Which pass changed the text most?
2. Which pass felt easiest?
3. Which pass do you most need in your real work?

PREPARATION FOR MODULE 6



Ready for Integrated Tasks?

Before you start the integrated task module, check whether you can do these four things without help:

- ☐ check whether a sentence is factually and grammatically controlled
- ☐ shorten or clarify a sentence that hides the main point
- ☐ soften wording that sounds blaming, abrupt, or too casual
- ☐ decide which editing pass should come first

If one of these still feels weak, return to the unit that teaches it and revise one more draft before moving on.

MODULE 6. Capstone & Applied Administrative Writing

Module Guide

Module 6 is the final applied stage of the book. In this module, you work with more than one document, more than one reader, or more than one revision decision at the same time. The units help you keep purpose, tone, detail, and consistency clear while still writing at an intermediate level.

The five units ask learners to manage more than one document, reader, or revision task at the same time:

- Unit 19 introduces integrated task writing — producing a connected email and internal explanation from the same scenario.
- Unit 20 develops revision combined with new writing — improving an existing draft while producing a related notice.
- Unit 21 addresses writing for consistency across a team — aligning the style and structure of multiple writers into one shared standard.
- Unit 22 extends to multi-document communication — managing email, explanation, and notice as a connected set for different readers.
- Unit 23 is the portfolio and final revision unit — reviewing a selection of writing from the whole book and explaining key revision choices.

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

- produce connected documents for different readers from one scenario
- control the differences between external, internal, and team-facing communication
- standardise multiple drafts into one clear team style
- review a small portfolio of writing and explain key revision choices

Use each part of this module to help your writing:

- compare the example versions before you draft
- read the “Why this works” note for reader and document control
- use the self-check before freer or final writing
- complete the editing practice so you separate reader needs clearly
- use the transfer extension to show that the skill can move to a new multi-document context

19

Integrated Task 1: Combined Email + Internal Explanation

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify what different audiences need to know about the same situation.
- write a polite external email about an issue.
- write a short internal explanation of the same issue.
- adjust tone and detail when the audience changes.

A. WARM-UP

**Understand the Shared Scenario**

Read the scenario and answer the questions.

Scenario: An external office reports that the applicant's Form B - Declaration does not include a required signature. The office asks your team to confirm whether a corrected version will be submitted. Your colleague also needs a short internal explanation of the issue and the next step.

1. What is the problem?
2. What information does the external office need?
3. What information does your team need internally?
4. What tone should you use in each message?

**Before You Write Two Texts from One Scenario**

- decide who each reader is
- decide what each reader needs to know
- keep the facts the same, but change the tone and detail

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

LEARN Why Two Documents Are Needed

In this unit, one situation produces **two different writing jobs**.

The external email and the internal explanation should not sound the same because the readers need different things.

The outside reader needs:

- a polite clear question
- enough background to understand the case

The internal reader needs:

- a factual explanation
- the effect on the team's work

Good multi-document writing keeps the same facts but changes:

- tone
- detail
- immediate purpose

C. LANGUAGE

LANGUAGE Writing for Two Audiences

External Email (Polite, Clear, Concise)

- Thank you for your message.
- We have checked the documents...
- Could you please confirm...?
- We appreciate your assistance.

Internal Explanation (Neutral, Informative)

- The external office informed us that...
- The issue concerns...
- The applicant will need to...
- Further updates will follow once...

If the two texts sound almost the same, the reader focus is probably too weak.

REWRITE Practice A: Rewrite for Audience & Tone

Rewrite each sentence for the correct audience.

External Office -> Make it polite

"Send us the correct form."

Internal Team -> Make it neutral and concise

"They said the applicant messed up the form again."

External Office -> Make it complete and professional

"What is the problem?"

Internal Team -> Make it clear and factual

"The form is wrong but they didn't explain well."

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Write the External Email

Use the Unit 19 scenario. Write a short external follow-up email to the external office.

Include:

- Subject line
- Thank-you / acknowledgement
- Background sentence
- One clear question about the missing signature or the resubmission step
- Polite closing

 WRITE **Write the Internal Explanation**

Use the same facts from the scenario. Write a short internal explanation for your colleagues or team.

Include:

- Background
- Description of the issue
- What is needed next
- Next steps or expected follow-up

Keep the internal explanation different from the external email. The email asks the outside office for action or clarification. The internal explanation helps colleagues understand the issue and prepare the next step.

You can use this simple frame:

1. We received an update about ...
2. The main issue is ...
3. We now need to ...
4. The next step will be ...

Reader-purpose reminder:

- External email: asks the outside office for action or confirmation.
- Internal explanation: helps colleagues understand the issue, the effect on the work, and the next internal step.

E. FREER PRACTICE



STRUCTURE

Plan for Each Reader

Before writing the full pair, note the same situation in two different ways.

Control point	External email	Internal explanation
Main job	ask for action or clarification	help the team understand the issue
Tone	polite, cooperative	neutral, factual
Key fact that must stay the same		
Detail that this reader needs most		
Next step to mention		

Writers often lose reader focus because they start drafting too quickly. This board slows the decision down just enough to keep the two texts linked but not identical.



WRITE

Choose One Integrated Scenario

Choose one scenario and write **both**:

1. A short external inquiry email (4-5 sentences)
2. A short internal explanation (4-5 sentences)

Choose from these options:

- A. A document is submitted in the wrong file format.
- B. The external office reports inconsistent applicant information.
- C. The review team needs clarification about a new submission rule.

Make it clear who each text is for and what that reader needs to know from the same scenario. Keep the facts the same, but change the audience and tone.

 EDIT

Rewrite the weak pair below so the external and internal texts do different jobs.

Write a clearer external version and a clearer internal version.

Internal revision

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

EDIT Final Self-Check

After writing and editing, check:

- ☐ Did I change the tone for each reader?
- ☐ Did I keep the facts consistent across both texts?
- ☐ Does each text have a different immediate purpose?
- ☐ Will each reader understand what matters to them?
- ☐ Did I keep the internal explanation factual rather than question-focused?

WRITE Reflect on the Audience Shift

1. Which audience shift created the biggest writing change in your pair: tone, detail, or sequence?
2. Which fact stayed the same across both texts, and which detail changed because only one reader needed it?
3. How would this two-audience skill help prevent confusion or extra follow-up in real administrative work?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

REWRITE Same Fact, New Audience Pair

Choose one earlier unit task. Rewrite it as:

- one short external message
- one short internal message

Use the same core facts, but change the tone and detail for each audience.

External message

Internal message

WRITE Rewrite for an Alternate Audience

Choose one email you wrote in a previous unit. Rewrite it for an alternate audience (external -> internal or internal -> external).

Keep the main facts the same, but change the tone, detail, and immediate purpose for the new reader.

20

Integrated Task 2: Revision + Notice Writing

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- write a polite revision or correction message to another office.
- write a short internal notice about the same correction.
- explain a corrected detail clearly and concisely.
- adapt the same information for external and internal audiences.

A. WARM-UP



NOTICE Understand the Correction Scenario

Read the scenario and answer the questions.

Scenario: Your office previously shared the monthly review schedule with an external office. A colleague later discovers that the date for Document Verification - Stage 2 was listed as 24 May, but the correct date is 27 May. You now need to send a polite correction message to the external office and an internal notice for your team.

1. What information needs revision?
2. Who needs to receive the corrected date?
3. Should the tone be the same for external and internal communication? Why/why not?
4. What details must be included in each message?



LEARN For Connected Documents, Check

- the correction is the same in both texts
- the important date or detail is consistent
- the audience and purpose are different

B. EXAMPLE CHECK



LEARN Why Connected Documents Need Control

This unit is not only about writing two texts. It is about keeping one corrected fact stable across both texts.

Revision writing becomes trustworthy when:

- the corrected detail stays the same everywhere
- the external version is polite and complete
- the internal version is factual and efficient

If the correction changes **between** texts, the writing may create more confusion instead of solving it.

C. LANGUAGE



LANGUAGE Revision vs. Notice

Revision Message (External Office)

Purpose: Correct previously shared information. Tone: Polite, clear, concise. **Useful Phrases**

- Thank you for your cooperation.
- We would like to provide a correction regarding...
- The correct date is...
- We apologise for any confusion.

Internal Notice (Colleagues)

Purpose: Inform staff of the correction. Tone: Neutral, informative. **Useful Phrases**

- Please note the following correction...
- The updated schedule is...
- This change affects...
- Further updates will follow.

The external revision message repairs the relationship with the outside reader. The internal notice repairs shared team understanding.



REWRITE Practice A: Rewrite for Audience & Tone

Rewrite each sentence for the appropriate audience.

External Office -> Make it polite and clear

"The schedule was wrong. Here is the real date."

Internal Team -> Make it neutral and concise

"Someone made a mistake in the schedule."

External Office -> Make it complete

"The day changed."

Internal Team -> Make it professional

"We told them the wrong date."

D. GUIDED PRACTICE

 WRITE Write the Revision Message

Use the Unit 20 scenario. Write a short message to the external office that received the earlier schedule.

Include:

- Greeting
 - Thank-you sentence
 - Reference to the previously shared schedule
 - The correction
 - Optional brief apology
 - Polite closing
-
-
-

 WRITE **Write the Internal Notice**

Use the same facts from the scenario. Write a short internal notice for colleagues in your section.

Include:

- Heading/topic
- Background (what was originally shared)
- The corrected date
- Impact or next steps

E. FREER PRACTICE

 STRUCTURE **Correction Control Board**

Use this board before drafting the full pair.

Question	External revision message	Internal notice
What was the original incorrect detail?		
What is the corrected detail?		
Who reads this text?		
What action should the reader take now?		
What tone is most useful here?		

Many weak correction sets change the wording of the correction itself. If the corrected fact changes between the two documents, the pair becomes less useful than the original mistake.

Keep the corrected fact identical. Change the tone, format, and amount of explanation around that fact.

 **WRITE**

Choose One Scenario

Choose one and write both texts:

1. A revision/clarification message (4-5 sentences)
2. A short internal notice (4-5 sentences)

Choose from these options:

- A. A deadline was listed incorrectly.
- B. A required document name was written incorrectly.
- C. An instruction in a previous email was unclear or incomplete.

Keep the two texts connected to the same correction, but change the tone and purpose for the two audiences. Keep the facts the same, but change the audience and tone.

[illegible]

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Repair the Correction Set

Rewrite this weak pair so both texts stay consistent.

Weak external draft: The meeting date may change. **Weak internal draft:** The new meeting date is 27 May.

Write a clearer external revision message and a clearer internal notice.

External revision

Internal notice revision

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Self-Check

After writing and editing, ask:

- ☐ Is the correction exactly the same in both texts?
- ☐ Is the external tone more polite?
- ☐ Is the internal version shorter and more factual?
- ☐ Can each reader see what happens next?
- ☐ Did both texts name the same corrected detail?



Reflect on This Unit

1. Which document did the heavier communication job in your pair: the revision message or the internal notice?
2. What changed most between the two texts: the tone, the amount of detail, or the action for the reader?
3. How can a well-written correction message reduce repeated errors or repeated questions later?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION



Correction Log

Write a short correction log for one scenario in this unit:

- original incorrect detail
- corrected detail
- who needs the correction
- what document each reader receives



Rewrite One Earlier Message

Choose a message from a previous unit. Rewrite it as:

- a revision email, or
- an internal notice

21

Writing for Consistency Across a Team

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- identify inconsistency across related team messages.
- rewrite short messages so they follow a shared team standard.
- explain simple team writing rules.
- revise a set of related messages into one professional style.

A. WARM-UP

**What Should Stay Consistent?**

Before you compare full messages, think about what a team should keep consistent in its writing.

Write two areas where team messages should follow a shared standard.

B. EXAMPLE CHECK

**Spot the Inconsistencies**

Compare the two emails. Identify inconsistencies in tone, format, structure, and clarity.

Email A

Subject: Info
Hi,
I saw it. What next?
Thx.

Email B

Subject: Information Required for Review

Dear Team,
We reviewed the application this morning and need confirmation about the submission date. Could you clarify this point?
Thank you.

Write the inconsistencies you notice.

 LEARN Why Team Consistency Helps

If one team sends very different styles of email, readers may feel:

- unsure which message is correct
- unsure how formal the communication should be
- unsure what to do next

Consistency helps because the reader can recognize the team's style quickly:

- standard subject line
- standard opening
- standard body pattern
- standard closing

C. LANGUAGE

 LEARN When multiple team members write emails and notices, inconsistency can cause

- Confusion for external offices
- Mixed tone (too direct / too soft)
- Different formats for similar tasks
- Repeated questions or follow-up emails

 LEARN Clear team standards help

- Maintain a professional image
- Improve readability
- Reduce miscommunication

- Support smoother administrative procedures



STRUCTURE

A shared team standard usually covers

- opening and closing style
- tone level
- structure of the body
- formatting basics



LANGUAGE

Standardising Team Writing

Standard Openings

- Dear [Office/Team],
- Thank you for your message.

Standard Purpose Statements

- I am writing to confirm...
- We would like to request...
- We have a question regarding...

Standard Closings

- Thank you.
- Please let us know if you need further information.
- Kind regards,

Formatting Standards

- clear paragraph breaks
- professional spacing
- complete sentences
- consistent subject line format

Team consistency is a reader-support tool, not only a style preference.



REWRITE

Practice A: Improve Team Consistency

Rewrite these sentences/emails to make them consistent with team standards.

1. Hi, I checked it. What should I do now?

1. Hello, Please check. I think there is a problem.

1. Team, The file is wrong. Fix it.
-
-

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Standardise Format & Tone

Read the draft email below. Rewrite it with correct formatting, tone, and clarity. Use one shared team pattern:

- clear subject line
- short professional greeting
- one main purpose sentence
- one supporting detail or request
- consistent closing

After rewriting, check whether another teammate could send the same message style without changing the structure.

Mini standard:

- Subject: clear topic
- Opening: short professional greeting
- Purpose: one direct sentence near the top
- Detail: one supporting fact or request
- Closing: neutral and consistent

Original Draft

Subject: Document
Hey, I don't think this is right. Check it and tell me.



Revised Email

E. FREER PRACTICE



Rewrite Three Short Messages

Rewrite all three so they follow **the same team-wide style**. Treat them as short draft messages from different colleagues that need to match one shared team standard.

Message 1

We didn't get the form. Send it.

Message 2

I saw your message. We need more details.

Message 3

The applicant file is strange. Please check.



Rewrite Two Related Messages to One Standard

Choose **one** of the situations below and rewrite **both** messages so they follow one shared team standard.

Options

- A. A colleague wrote a short file-update email and a follow-up reminder, but the two messages use different openings, tone levels, and closing styles.
- B. A team mailbox message and a reply to an outside office describe the same deadline issue, but the structure and formatting do not match your team's normal pattern.
- C. Two internal update emails about the same review problem sound as if they were written by different offices, even though they should reflect one team standard.

For each pair, make sure both messages show:

- the same level of formality
- the same message structure
- the same closing style
- the same visible formatting logic

Use this quick rewrite plan:

1. decide the shared opening pattern
2. place the purpose sentence near the top in both messages
3. keep the body order similar
4. use the same closing style

Keep the facts the same, but standardise the style, structure, and visible formatting logic.

[illegible]

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Build One Standard

Take one message from your guided practice and revise it again so it matches the same team pattern even more clearly. Then note:

- ☐ which consistency rule you applied
- ☐ how the revised version became easier to read

Revised message

Team rule

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Self-Check

After writing and revising, check:

- ☐ Do all messages sound like they come from one team?
- ☐ Is the tone level stable?
- ☐ Is the structure similar across the messages?

- ☐ Is the formatting predictable?
- ☐ Could another teammate reuse the same pattern?

 WRITE **Reflect on This Unit**

1. Which kind of inconsistency is most damaging in a team setting: tone drift, structure drift, or formatting drift?
2. Which standard phrase or rule from this unit would be most useful as a shared team default?
3. When should team messages stay identical in style, and when should they still adapt to audience or purpose?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 WRITE **Turn One Rewrite into a Team Rule**

Choose one consistency feature from your freer-practice pair.

Write:

1. the rule in one short sentence
2. one example your team should use
3. one example your team should avoid

 REVISE **Rewrite the Pair with a New Team Standard**

Choose one of the Unit 21 situations and rewrite the two messages again using a slightly different but still consistent team standard.

If you want to use real workplace writing, you may do so, but it is not required.

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- decide what different readers need from the same situation.
- write an applicant reply, a colleague explanation, and an internal notice about one issue.
- adapt tone, detail, and structure across three related documents.
- keep multiple related messages clear and consistent.

A. WARM-UP

 NOTICE Analyse the Three-Reader Situation

Read the scenario and answer the questions.

Scenario: You receive an email from an applicant asking why their application status has not been updated. After reviewing the system, you discover that one document from the applicant is missing, the review team cannot proceed without it, and a colleague had previously assumed the file was complete.

- One document from the applicant is missing.
 - The review team cannot proceed without it.
 - A colleague had previously assumed the file was complete.
1. What does the applicant need to know?
 2. What does your colleague need to understand?
 3. What information does the team need in a notice?
 4. How should tone differ in each message?

 LEARN Before You Write a Multi-Document Set

- list the three readers

- note the main fact all three documents must share
- decide what detail level each reader needs

B. EXAMPLE CHECK



Why Audience Control Matters

This unit is stronger than earlier units because one situation now requires **three** reader views.

That means you must control:

- what stays the same
- what changes

The main fact stays the same. The tone, detail, and purpose change.

If all three texts sound the same, the communication set does not match the real workplace need.

C. LANGUAGE



Three Audiences, Three Styles

(A) Applicant Reply - Polite, supportive, clear

- Thank you for your message.
- We have checked your application status.
- One document has not yet been received.
- We will update the status once...

(B) Colleague Message - Neutral, cooperative

- I reviewed the applicant file and noticed...
- The status has not been updated because...
- Once the document is received, we can...

(C) Internal Notice - Concise, factual

- Please note the following update...
- The applicant's file remains incomplete.
- The review will continue once the missing document is submitted.

The applicant reply, colleague explanation, and team notice are linked, but they should not collapse into one generic message.



Practice A: Match Tone to Audience

Rewrite each sentence for the appropriate audience.

1. (Applicant) "You didn't upload the file we need."

1. (Colleague) "The applicant didn't follow the instructions again."

1. (Internal Notice) "The file is wrong and causing trouble."

1. (Applicant) "Send the document quickly."

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Write the Applicant Reply

Use the Unit 22 scenario. Write a short email replying directly to the applicant. Include:

- Thank-you / acknowledgement
- Background
- Clear explanation of the missing document
- What will happen next
- Polite closing

**Write the Colleague Explanation**

Use the same facts from the scenario. Write a short explanation for the colleague who assumed the file was complete. Include:

- What you checked
- What you found
- Why the status has not changed
- What steps will follow

**Write the Internal Notice**

Use the same facts from the scenario. Write a short notice for the wider team. Include:

- Heading/topic
- The key issue (missing document)
- The effect on the review process
- Next steps

Think about what the wider team needs most:

- the corrected fact
- the effect on the workflow
- the action staff should take now

You can use this pattern:

1. topic or heading
2. key issue
3. action or reminder for staff

Mini notice reminder:

- Team Notice: Missing Applicant Document
- One required document is still missing from the applicant's file.

- The review will continue after the missing document is received and checked.

E. FREER PRACTICE



STRUCTURE

Three Documents from One Situation

Before drafting the full set, map the same situation across the three readers.

Reader	Main need	Detail level	Tone	Next action
Applicant				
Colleague				
Team notice readers				

In a three-document task, the biggest risk is not grammar. It is overlap. One message starts doing another message's job. Use this quick test:

- if a sentence helps only the applicant, keep it out of the team notice
- if a sentence explains team workflow only, keep it out of the applicant reply
- if a sentence helps the colleague understand the status logic, it may belong only in the colleague version



WRITE

Full Multi-Document Set

Choose **one** of the scenarios below and write all three documents:

1. Applicant reply (5-6 sentences)
2. Colleague message (4-5 sentences)
3. Internal notice (3-4 sentences)

Choose from these options:

- A. A system error prevented an applicant's file from uploading correctly.
- B. Two versions of a form were submitted; one is incomplete.
- C. The applicant sent the correct file, but in the wrong format.

Keep the three documents tied to the same scenario, but make the audience difference clear in each one. Keep the facts the same, but change the audience, detail, and tone.

[illegible]

F. EDITING PRACTICE

EDIT Separate the Three Voices

Rewrite the short draft below into three clearer document openings.

Weak draft: The applicant is missing one file and the team needs to know and the colleague also misunderstood the status.

Write:

- ☐ applicant opening
- ☐ colleague opening
- ☐ team notice opening

Applicant opening

Colleague opening

Team notice opening

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION

EDIT Final Self-Check

After writing and revising, check:

- ☐ Did I identify the three readers clearly?
- ☐ Does each document have a different job?
- ☐ Are the shared facts consistent across all three?

- ☐ Is the tone right for each audience?
- ☐ Did I keep the three texts from sounding too similar?

 WRITE **Reflect on This Unit**

1. Which of the three audiences required the biggest adjustment in tone or detail?
2. Which two documents were easiest to separate clearly, and which pair was hardest to keep separate?
3. What planning step would help you control consistency across all three documents next time?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 STRUCTURE **Cross-Document Consistency Check**

Before finalizing the pack, compare the three drafts line by line.

Check point	Applicant email	Colleague explanation	Internal notice
same missing document named clearly			
same status of the review process			
same next step or condition for progress			
tone matches the reader			
unnecessary detail removed			



Rewrite the Three-Document Set

Choose one scenario from the freer practice section. Rewrite the three documents again using a different tone or structure.

23

Portfolio Writing & Final Revision

FOCUS

By the end of this unit, I will be able to:

- revise earlier writing to a higher standard.
- choose portfolio pieces that show different administrative writing skills.
- produce a new final document that matches the portfolio standard.
- review my writing for accuracy, clarity, tone, clear connections, and concise wording.

A. WARM-UP



STRUCTURE

Build Your Portfolio Set

A writing portfolio is a collection of your **best revised work**. It should show range, revision quality, and professional control across different writing jobs.

This opening task prepares the three earlier pieces before you build the full portfolio set.

In this unit, your portfolio will contain:

1. One external-style email (revised and final)
2. One internal explanation or notice (revised and final)
3. One paragraph for a report (revised and final)
4. One new document created in Unit 23

Look back at your writing from Units 1-22. Choose the three earlier drafts you want to revise for your portfolio:

1. one email
2. one paragraph
3. one short notice, message, or internal explanation

B. EXAMPLE CHECK



LEARN

What a Strong Portfolio Shows

A portfolio is not only a folder of old drafts. It should show that you can:

- notice problems in earlier writing
- improve a document for a real reader
- choose the right tone and structure
- produce final versions that feel usable

Choose **two priorities** you most want your portfolio to show. Write one short reason for each choice.

1. revision quality
2. audience and tone control
3. clear structure and flow
4. consistent professional style

C. LANGUAGE



STRUCTURE

Portfolio Revision Checklist

Before revising your drafts, check for:

Accuracy

- Verb forms, articles, prepositions, plurals

Clarity

- Simple, direct sentences
- No vague language

Tone

- Polite, neutral, professional
- Appropriate for audience (external, internal, colleague)

Clear connections

- Clear connections between ideas
- Logical flow

Concise wording

- Remove unnecessary repetition
- Avoid long or wordy expressions



Final Revision Order

Use this order each time you revise:

1. check accuracy
2. check clarity and flow
3. check tone for the reader
4. check formatting and consistency

D. GUIDED PRACTICE



Guided Revision Set

Revise three earlier pieces for your portfolio. Use the checklist in Activity C each time.

1. Revise one email

Choose **one email** from your previous work. Rewrite it to meet portfolio standards. Choose one that is meant for a clear reader such as an applicant, colleague, supervisor, team, or outside office.

2. Revise one paragraph

Choose **one paragraph** from earlier units. Rewrite it using your full editing skills. Choose one explanation, summary, procedure, or report-style paragraph.

Before revising, mark:

- one sentence that is too vague
- one sentence that needs better order or connection
- one sentence that needs more professional tone

After revising, check whether the paragraph now has a clearer reader, purpose, and logical flow.

Revision focus:

- make the main point easier to find
- connect supporting details to that main point
- remove wording that sounds casual, repetitive, or unfocused

3. Revise one notice or short message

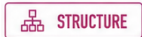
Choose **one notice or message** from previous units. Rewrite it clearly and professionally. Choose one short text with a clear internal or external audience. Use this quick editing routine:

1. identify the audience
2. remove unclear or emotional wording
3. make the main point easy to find
4. add the next action or needed detail if it is missing

Mini edit test:

- Can the reader see the main point in one read?
- Does the message sound neutral and workplace-appropriate?
- Would the reader know what to do next?

E. FREER PRACTICE



STRUCTURE

Portfolio Assembly Board

Use this board before creating the final set.

Portfolio item	Reader	Main job	Strongest skill it shows	What still needs revision
Revised external email				
Revised internal explanation or notice				
Revised report-style paragraph				
New Unit 23 document				

Why this works

A weaker portfolio often repeats the same writing job in slightly different forms. A stronger portfolio shows range: different readers, different purposes, and visible revision improvement.

Before finalizing, check:

- Do two items sound too similar?
- Is one item clearly weaker than the rest?
- Does the new Unit 23 document add a skill the earlier pieces do not already show?



WRITE

Create a New Portfolio Document

Write **one new document** based on a scenario below. Choose ONE:

- A clear update email to a colleague, supervisor, or applicant (6-8 sentences)
- A meeting summary for a colleague or manager (5-6 sentences)
- A short external inquiry email to another office (5-6 sentences)
- A problem explanation for an internal report (6-8 sentences)



Final Portfolio Submission

Your final portfolio should contain **four items**:

1. One external-style email (revised)
2. One internal explanation or notice (revised)
3. One paragraph for a report (revised)
4. One new document created in Unit 23

Each item must:

- Use accurate grammar
- Be clear and concise
- Have professional tone
- Show clear connections and consistent formatting

Before you submit, confirm that the four items show a useful range of skills:

- at least one external-facing document
- at least one internal-facing document
- at least one paragraph-length text
- one new Unit 23 document that fits the rest of the portfolio

Short submission check:

1. Are the readers different across the set?
2. Does each document do a clear workplace job?
3. Did I revise, not just copy, the earlier texts?
4. Does the new document match the quality of the revised pieces?

Write each final document in its own box.

Revised External Email

Revised Internal Explanation or Notice

Revised Report Paragraph

New Unit 23 Document

F. EDITING PRACTICE



Rebuild the Weakest Piece

If one portfolio item still feels weaker than the rest, do not only proofread it. Run this short rebuild routine:

- ☐ underline the sentence that does the main job
- ☐ check whether the reader is clear in the opening
- ☐ circle one vague or unnecessary phrase
- ☐ replace one sentence so the next action becomes clearer
- ☐ read the whole document once more for tone consistency

Rebuild question

What is this document supposed to help the reader do next?

If that answer is not obvious, the document still needs revision even if the grammar looks acceptable.

Write a short revision note for that piece:

- one problem in the original draft
- how you revised it

G. SELF-CHECK AND REFLECTION



Final Submission Check

Before you submit your portfolio, ask:

- ☐ Does each document match its reader and purpose?
- ☐ Did I improve accuracy, clarity, and tone?
- ☐ Are the final versions consistent in formatting and style?
- ☐ Does the new Unit 23 document fit the rest of the portfolio?



Portfolio Review Rubric

Use this rubric to check your final portfolio. Mark each criterion as:

- Ready
- Almost ready
- Needs more revision

Criterion	What to check	Review units
Task completion	Did I include all four required portfolio items, and does each document match its purpose?	Units 4, 9, 11, 12, 22
Audience and tone	Does each piece match its reader and sound professional?	Units 2, 12, 14, 18, 22
Clarity and organisation	Is each document easy to follow, with a clear main point and logical order?	Units 1, 3, 10, 17

Criterion	What to check	Review units
Accuracy and control	Are grammar, word forms, sentence structure, and punctuation accurate enough for workplace writing?	Units 1, 16
Key information and next steps	Did I include the needed background, main point, and next action or outcome where needed?	Units 6, 10, 11, 13, 20
Consistency and revision quality	Did I improve earlier drafts and keep a consistent professional style across the whole portfolio?	Units 15, 18, 21

Use the checklist and rubric together. If any area is still weak, rebuild that document before final submission.

 WRITE Reflection

Reflect on this unit.

1. Which portfolio item improved the most after revision, and what specific editing decision caused that improvement?
2. Which skill area now feels strongest in your work: accuracy, clarity, tone, reader focus, or document structure? Why?

H. HOMEWORK & EXTENSION

 WRITE Extension: Next-Time Writing Plan

Write a short plan for future workplace writing.

Include:

- one strength you want to keep using
- one editing habit you want to remember
- one area you still want to improve



Homework: Final Course Task

Module 6 Review Workshop

KEY LESSONS TO KEEP



LEARN

Core Takeaways

- Unit 19: One situation may require two documents because different readers need different kinds of help.
- Unit 20: A revision message and an internal notice can come from the same event, but they do different jobs.
- Unit 21: Team consistency matters because the reader experiences the office as one organisation, not as separate writers.
- Unit 22: Multi-document communication works only when each audience receives the right level of detail and tone.
- Unit 23: Portfolio review turns revision into a deliberate habit instead of a last-minute correction.

MULTI-DOCUMENT COMPARISON

Read these two communication sets for the same situation: an applicant submitted the wrong form and the team needs to react.

Version A

Please send the correct form. We also need to tell the team there is a delay. Everyone should know there is a problem.

Version B

External message: Thank you for your submission. We noticed that the attached form is not the required version. Could you please send the updated form by Thursday?
Internal note: The file submitted today does not match the required template. Please pause the next review step until the corrected form arrives.



WRITE

Review Response

Write **2-3 sentences** explaining why Version B is stronger. Mention audience control, document purpose, and consistency.

REVISION LAB

Single Weak Response

There is a document problem. Please send the correct form. We will also tell the team there is a delay and everyone should wait.



Rebuild the Communication Set

Rebuild the weak response as a stronger set:

1. External message:
 - thank the reader
 - name the exact document problem
 - ask for one clear action
 - give a professional deadline or next step

External Message

1. Internal message:
 - explain the same fact neutrally
 - tell the team what to pause, continue, or watch
 - remove any sentence that only belongs in the external message

Internal Message

1. Revision note:

- explain why the external and internal versions need different wording
- explain which reader needed different detail or tone
- explain which Module 5 editing pass improved the set most

Revision Note

SELF-EDIT ROUTINE

 Check and Revise One Integrated Set

Choose one integrated task set from Units 19-23. Use the checklist, then revise the weakest opening or next-step sentence.

- ☐ Check each document separately for purpose, reader, and next action.
- ☐ Compare the tone across the documents and confirm that each one fits its audience.
- ☐ Check whether facts stay consistent when the audience changes.
- ☐ Remove one sentence that belongs in a different document.
- ☐ Add one sentence that makes the next step clearer.

Revised opening or next-step sentence

FINAL COURSE TRANSFER TASK

WRITE Create a Final Communication Pack

Create one complete administrative communication pack about a realistic case such as:

- wrong applicant document
- delayed approval from another office
- change to a deadline or procedure
- correction to earlier shared information

Include:

- one external-facing message
- one internal explanation or notice
- one short style or revision note for your team

External-Facing Message

Internal Explanation or Notice

Style or Revision Note

After writing, complete this final reflection:

1. Which document required the most careful audience control?
2. Where did you apply sentence, tone, and paragraph skills from Module 1?
3. Which earlier module helped most with explanation and structure?
4. Which Module 5 editing habit improved the pack most?
5. What would you still revise if you had one more draft?

PORTFOLIO COMPLETION CHECK



Final Portfolio Check

Before final submission, choose one portfolio item and check it against this ladder:

1. Draft stage:
 - identify the reader and purpose.
2. Control stage:
 - mark the main sentence, supporting detail, and next-step line.
3. Revision stage:
 - improve accuracy, clarity, and tone.
4. Portfolio stage:
 - compare the item to the other pieces and decide what skill range it adds.
5. Final reflection stage:

- explain one revision decision that made the document more useful.

Use these prompts:

- Which portfolio item is the strongest example of audience control?
- Which item still needs the clearest next-step line?
- Which item benefits most from a Module 5 editing pass?
- Which item best proves that the portfolio is a set of deliberate revisions rather than disconnected exercises?
